

Philippine Culture AI Knowledge Base

Province-level cultural profiles for fast retrieval and grounded responses

Scope	82 provinces plus a metropolitan profile for the National Capital Region
Administrative basis	Philippine Standard Geographic Code (PSGC) as of 31 March 2026
Cultural fields	festivals, food, historical places, heroes and figures, history, games, instruments, music, languages and speech varieties, and folk or ritual dances
Format	searchable, text-first PDF with one standardized record per province and a JSONL companion index
Prepared	July 2026

Use note. This document provides representative, non-exhaustive cultural information. Festivals can be renamed, rescheduled, suspended, or localized by LGUs. Cultural practices may be shared across provincial boundaries and should not be treated as exclusive to one place.

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How to Use This Knowledge Base

This PDF is optimized for retrieval-augmented generation (RAG). Each province begins on a new page, uses a stable record identifier based on the 10-digit PSGC code, and repeats the same field labels. This structure helps an AI retrieve exact passages instead of searching long narrative chapters.

Recommended chunk boundary	One province record per chunk or page. Do not merge adjacent provinces.
Suggested chunk size	Approximately 450-750 tokens; 40-80 tokens of overlap only when a parser splits a page.
Metadata filters	record_id, PSGC code, province, region, category, aliases, and source date.
Retrieval settings	Use exact-name matching before semantic search; retrieve top 3-5 chunks; use province or region metadata filters when present.
Latency target	A 1-3 second answer depends on precomputed embeddings, local or low-latency storage, caching, model speed, and network conditions. A PDF by itself cannot guarantee latency.
Answer behavior	State when information is representative or shared across regions. Ask for a municipality or cultural community when a question is more specific than the province-level scope.

Terminology. The word “dialect” is often used informally in the Philippines. In this document, named speech forms are listed as languages or varieties without implying that one is linguistically subordinate to another.

National Cultural Reference

Traditional games	Patintero, piko, tumbang preso, luksong tinik, luksong baka, sipa, sungka, palo-sebo, kadang-kadang, holen, trumpo, agawan base, arnis games, boat races, and community-specific contests.
Major instrument families	Rondalla strings; bamboo flutes, zithers, buzzers and percussion; Cordillera flat gongs; Mindanao kulintang ensembles; lutes such as kudyapi, hegelung and kudlong; drums, guitars and brass bands.
Music and oral traditions	Kundiman, kumintang, balitaw, komposo, pasyon, dallot, Hudhud, ullalim, Darangen, Tudbulul, ambahan, kulilal, tultul, rawit-dawit, siday, bayok, lugu and regional work, ritual and devotional songs.
Folk and ritual dances	Tinikling, cariñosa, pandanggo, kuratsa, subli, maglalatik, sakuting, binatbatan, banga, ragsaksakan, singkil, sagayan, pangalay, binanog, lapay bantigue, pantomina, kuradang and community-specific ritual dances.
Cultural caution	Many foods, songs, instruments and dances cross provincial borders. The province pages identify strong associations and living communities, not exclusive ownership.

National Capital Region (NCR)

PSGC region code: 1300000000 | 2024 population: 14,001,751 | Provinces: 0

A metropolitan cultural center built on the historic Tagalog polities of Tondo and Maynila. Manila became the Spanish colonial capital in 1571, was devastated in 1945, and later developed into a national center for government, education, publishing, theater, film, music, museums, and migration from every Philippine region.

Cultural communities	Tagalog urban communities and migrant communities from all major Philippine ethnolinguistic groups
Languages and speech varieties	Filipino/Tagalog and English; Cebuano, Ilocano, Hiligaynon, Bicol, Waray, Kapampangan, Pangasinan, Maranao, Tausug, Maguindanaon, and many other migrant languages
Games and recreation	patintero; tumbang preso; piko; luksong tinik; sipa; sungka
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments such as bandurria, octavina, laud, guitar, and bass; brass-band and percussion instruments
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, awit, sarsuwela music, marching-band traditions, Manila sound, and contemporary Original Pilipino Music (OPM)
Folk and ritual dances	cariñosa, pandango, jota and rigodon forms, urban fiesta dances, and nationally taught folk dances

National Capital Region (metropolitan profile)

Record ID: PH-1300000000 | PSGC: 1300000000 | 2024 population: 14,001,751

The National Capital Region is a metropolitan cultural center built on the historic Tagalog polities of Tondo and Maynila and enriched by migration from every Philippine region.

Festivals and festivities	Feast of the Black Nazarene; Chinese New Year in Binondo; Aliwan Fiesta; local city festivals such as La Loma Lechon Festival, Caracol, and Pasig Bambino Festival
Food and culinary culture	Manila-style pancit and mami; Binondo Chinese-Filipino dishes; street food; regional cuisines represented across the metropolis
Historical and cultural places	Intramuros and Fort Santiago; San Agustin Church; Rizal Park; Binondo; Bonifacio Monument; Quezon Memorial Circle; EDSA Shrine
Heroes and notable figures	José Rizal; Andres Bonifacio; Melchora Aquino; Jacinto Zamora; Apolinario Mabini and many national figures commemorated in the capital
History snapshot	Tondo and Maynila were important precolonial Tagalog trading polities. Manila became the Spanish colonial capital in 1571, was heavily destroyed in 1945, and later became the center of the republic's national institutions.
Games and recreation	patintero; tumbang preso; piko; luksong tinik; sipa; sungka
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments such as bandurria, octavina, laud, guitar, and bass; brass-band and percussion instruments
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, awit, sarsuwela music, marching-band traditions, Manila sound, and contemporary Original Pilipino Music (OPM)
Languages and speech varieties	Filipino/Tagalog and English; Cebuano, Ilocano, Hiligaynon, Bicol, Waray, Kapampangan, Pangasinan, Maranao, Tausug, Maguindanaon, and many other migrant languages
Folk and ritual dances	cariñosa, pandango, jota and rigodon forms, urban fiesta dances, and nationally taught folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Metro Manila; Manila metropolitan culture; NCR culture; National Capital Region culture
Scope note	NCR has no provinces; this is a metropolitan profile covering shared culture across its cities and Pateros.

Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR)

PSGC region code: 1400000000 | 2024 population: 1,808,985 | Provinces: 6

The Cordillera highlands are home to distinct Indigenous communities with rice-terrace agriculture, customary law, peace-pact traditions, woodcarving, weaving, oral epics, gong music, and strong ancestral-domain identities.

Cultural communities	Ibaloy, Kankanaey, Ifugao, Kalinga, Bontok, Itneg/Tingguian, Isnag, Kalanguya, Balangao, and related highland communities
Languages and speech varieties	Kankanaey, Ibaloy, Ifugao languages, Kalinga languages, Bontok, Itneg, Isnag, Kalanguya, Balangao, Ilocano, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diw, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles
Folk and ritual dances	tayaw, banga, ragsaksakan, pattong, salip, bendian, dinuyya, tadek, and other community-specific ritual or social dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Abra

Record ID: PH-1400100000 | PSGC: 1400100000 | Region: Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 2024 population: 246,948

Abra reflects the traditions of Itneg/Tinguian and Ilocano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Itneg/Tinguian and Ilocano communities
Festivals and festivities	Abrenian Kawayan Festival; Arya Abra; town fiestas
Food and culinary culture	Abra miki; palileng river fish; rice cakes; basi and sugarcane products
Historical and cultural places	Tayum Church; Gabriela Silang Gallery; Bangued heritage houses; Kaparkan cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Gabriela Silang; Diego Silang; Itneg elders and peace-pact leaders
History snapshot	An Itneg/Tinguian homeland later integrated into the Ilocos administrative sphere. Abra became a separate province in 1846 and is closely associated with the Silang resistance and Cordillera-lowland exchange.
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diw, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Itneg varieties such as Inlaud, Maeng, and Masadiit; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	tadek; tayaw; Itneg ceremonial dances; Ilocano social dances
Retrieval aliases	Abra; Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Benguet

Record ID: PH-1401100000 | PSGC: 1401100000 | Region: Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 2024 population: 473,190

Benguet reflects the traditions of Ibaloy, Kankanaey and Kalanguya communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ibaloy, Kankanaey and Kalanguya communities
Festivals and festivities	Adivay Festival; Strawberry Festival; Panagbenga in nearby Baguio
Food and culinary culture	strawberries; ube jam; etag; pinikpikan; highland vegetables
Historical and cultural places	Kabayan Mummies; Ibaloy heritage sites; Camp John Hay and Teachers Camp in Baguio; Mt. Pulag cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Mateo Cariño; Kidlat Tahimik; Ibaloy and Kankanaey cultural bearers
History snapshot	Benguet was a center of Ibaloy and Kankanaey communities before mining and American hill-station development transformed the highlands. It became a province in the 1966 reorganization of old Mountain Province.
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diw, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles
Languages and speech varieties	Ibaloy; Kankanaey; Kalanguya; Ilocano; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	bendian; tayaw; pattong; ragsaksakan; Ibaloy and Kankanaey dances
Retrieval aliases	Benguet; Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Ifugao

Record ID: PH-1402700000 | PSGC: 1402700000 | Region: Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 2024 population: 208,668

Ifugao reflects the traditions of Tuwali, Ayangan and other Ifugao communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tuwali, Ayangan and other Ifugao communities
Festivals and festivities	Gotad ad Ifugao; Imbayah Festival; harvest rites
Food and culinary culture	binakle; baya rice wine; pinikpikan; native rice; etag
Historical and cultural places	Banaue, Batad, Bangaan, Mayoyao and Hapao rice terraces; Kiangnan War Memorial; Ifugao Museum
Heroes and notable figures	Ifugao terrace keepers, mumbaki ritual specialists, and World War II veterans; regional figure Macli-ing Dulag
History snapshot	Ifugao culture is inseparable from rice-terrace engineering, muyong forest management, customary ritual, and the Hudhud chant tradition. Kiangnan is linked to the 1945 surrender of Japanese General Tomoyuki Yamashita.
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races; tug-of-war; rice-pounding contests; top spinning; terrace races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers; gangsa; bangibang percussion; nose flute; bamboo instruments
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diwi, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles; Hudhud chants and alim epics
Languages and speech varieties	Tuwali Ifugao; Ayangan Ifugao; Kalanguya; Ilocano; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	dinuyya; banga; uyauy; Ifugao harvest and prestige-feast dances
Retrieval aliases	Ifugao; Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Kalinga

Record ID: PH-1403200000 | PSGC: 1403200000 | Region: Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 2024 population: 235,391

Kalinga reflects the traditions of Kalinga communities and Ilocano settlers. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Kalinga communities and Ilocano settlers
Festivals and festivities	Ullalim Festival; Bodong Festival; Matagoan Festival
Food and culinary culture	Kalinga coffee; inandila rice cake; kini-ing smoked meat; heirloom rice
Historical and cultural places	Chico River; Buscalan Village; Kalinga Provincial Museum; bodong peace-pact sites
Heroes and notable figures	Macli-ing Dulag; Whang-od Oggay; Kalinga bodong holders
History snapshot	Kalinga society is known for the bodong peace-pact system, tattooing, gong music, and river-valley agriculture. The Chico River dam resistance became a major national symbol of Indigenous rights.
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races; spear throwing; archery; tug-of-war; river races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers; gangsa; tongatong; bamboo flute; solibao drum
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diw, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles; ullalim epic chanting; oggayam; salidummay
Languages and speech varieties	Kalinga language varieties; Ilocano; Bontok in border areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	salip; tadek; pattong; banga; Kalinga war and courtship dances
Retrieval aliases	Kalinga; Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Mountain Province

Record ID: PH-1404400000 | PSGC: 1404400000 | Region: Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 2024 population: 149,775

Mountain Province reflects the traditions of Bontok, Kankanaey, Balangao and related communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Bontok, Kankanaey, Balangao and related communities
Festivals and festivities	Lang-ay Festival; Etag Festival; municipal begnas celebrations
Food and culinary culture	etag; pinikpikan; native rice cakes; mountain coffee
Historical and cultural places	Sagada hanging coffins and caves; Bontoc Museum; Maligcong rice terraces; Mt. Data heritage sites
Heroes and notable figures	Bontok and Kankanaey elders, peace-pact makers, and cultural historians such as William Henry Scott
History snapshot	The province is the remaining core of the larger American-era Mountain Province after its 1966 division. Bontok and Sagada became major centers of highland education, ethnography, rice culture, and community ritual.
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diw, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles
Languages and speech varieties	Bontok; Kankanaey; Balangao; Ilocano; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pattong; tayaw; takik; banga; begnas ritual dances
Retrieval aliases	Mountain Province; Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Apayao

Record ID: PH-1408100000 | PSGC: 1408100000 | Region: Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) | 2024 population: 126,587

Apayao reflects the traditions of Isnag and Ilocano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Isnag and Ilocano communities
Festivals and festivities	Say-am Festival; Apayao Day celebrations
Food and culinary culture	etag; river fish dishes; native rice cakes; forest products
Historical and cultural places	Lussok Crystal Cave; Maton Underground River; Apayao River cultural landscape; Isnag settlements
Heroes and notable figures	Isnag community leaders and elders; Macli-ing Dulag as a wider Cordillera symbol of ancestral-domain defense
History snapshot	The province is an Isnag homeland shaped by river systems and forest life. It formed part of Kalinga-Apayao until the two provinces were separated in 1995.
Games and recreation	tug-of-war; spear-throwing and archery contests; arm wrestling; rice-pounding contests; community races
Instruments and material culture	gangsa flat gongs; solibao drums; tongatong bamboo percussion; kalaleng nose flute; bamboo zithers and buzzers
Music and oral traditions	Hudhud chants, ullalim epics, salidummay, oggayam, ba-diw, work songs, ritual chants, and gong ensembles
Languages and speech varieties	Isnag; Ilocano; Kalinga varieties in border areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Isnag ritual and victory dances; tayaw; gong dances
Retrieval aliases	Apayao; Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region I (Ilocos Region)

PSGC region code: 0100000000 | 2024 population: 5,342,453 | Provinces: 4

A northern lowland and coastal region shaped by Ilocano and Pangasinan traditions, weaving, salt and fish industries, farming, seafaring, Catholic fiestas, revolutionary history, and strong vernacular literature.

Cultural communities	Ilocano, Pangasinan, Bolinao, Sambal, and upland communities
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano, Pangasinan, Bolinao, Sambal varieties, Filipino/Tagalog, and English
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; palo-sebo; kadang-kadang; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments, guitar, bandurria, bamboo flute, drums, and town brass bands
Music and oral traditions	dallot improvised verse, dung-aw lament, Ilocano folk songs such as Pamulinawen and Manang Biday, and Pangasinan coastal songs
Folk and ritual dances	sakuting, binatbatan, Ilocana a Nasudi, oasiwas, sayaw ed tapew na bangko, and local pandanggo forms

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Ilocos Norte

Record ID: PH-0102800000 | PSGC: 0102800000 | Region: Region I (Ilocos Region) | 2024 population: 618,850

Ilocos Norte reflects the traditions of Ilocano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ilocano communities
Festivals and festivities	Pamulinawen Festival; Tan-ok ni Ilocano Festival; Guling-Guling Festival
Food and culinary culture	Ilocos empanada; bagnet; Ilocos longganisa; pinakbet; basi
Historical and cultural places	Paoay Church; Juan Luna Shrine; Cape Bojeador Lighthouse; Malacañang of the North; Paoay heritage landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Juan Luna; Antonio Luna; Gregorio Aglipay; Artemio Ricarte; Josefa Llanes Escoda
History snapshot	The northern half of historic Ilocos was formed as a separate province in 1818. It is associated with anti-colonial movements, the Aglipayan church, Ilocano migration, and prominent artists and revolutionaries.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; palo-sebo; kadang-kadang; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments, guitar, bandurria, bamboo flute, drums, and town brass bands
Music and oral traditions	dallot improvised verse, dung-aw lament, Ilocano folk songs such as Pamulinawen and Manang Biday, and Pangasinan coastal songs
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Filipino/Tagalog; English
Folk and ritual dances	sakuting; Ilocana a Nasudi; guling-guling; Ilocano pandanggo
Retrieval aliases	Ilocos Norte; Region I (Ilocos Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Ilocos Sur

Record ID: PH-0102900000 | PSGC: 0102900000 | Region: Region I (Ilocos Region) | 2024 population: 709,991

Ilocos Sur reflects the traditions of Ilocano and Itneg communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ilocano and Itneg communities
Festivals and festivities	Viva Vigan Binatbatan Festival; Kannawidan Ylocos Festival; Abel Festival
Food and culinary culture	Vigan longganisa; empanada; bagnet; royal bibingka; sinanglao
Historical and cultural places	Historic City of Vigan; Santa Maria Church; Bantay Bell Tower; Syquia Mansion; Crisologo Museum
Heroes and notable figures	Diego Silang; Gabriela Silang; Pedro Bukaneg; Leona Florentino; Jose Burgos
History snapshot	The province was the center of Spanish-era Ilocos and the base of the Silang uprising. Vigan preserves a major colonial trading-town landscape and a living tradition of abel weaving.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; palo-sebo; kadang-kadang; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments, guitar, bandurria, bamboo flute, drums, and town brass bands; rondalla; guitar; bamboo flute; loom-beating rhythms
Music and oral traditions	dallot improvised verse, dung-aw lament, Ilocano folk songs such as Pamulinawen and Manang Biday, and Pangasinan coastal songs; dallot; dung-aw; Ilocano poetry and folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Itneg varieties in uplands; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	binatbatan; sakuting; Ilocano courtship and occupational dances
Retrieval aliases	Ilocos Sur; Region I (Ilocos Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

La Union

Record ID: PH-0103300000 | PSGC: 0103300000 | Region: Region I (Ilocos Region) | 2024 population: 825,072

La Union reflects the traditions of Ilocano, Pangasinan and upland Kankanaey/Ibaloy communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ilocano, Pangasinan and upland Kankanaey/Ibaloy communities
Festivals and festivities	Dinengdeng Festival; La Union Surfing Break; Pindangan Festival
Food and culinary culture	tupig; dinengdeng; grape products and local wines; basi
Historical and cultural places	Pindangan Ruins; Baluarte Watchtower in Luna; Ma-Cho Temple; Bahay na Bato; old churches
Heroes and notable figures	Manuel Arguilla; local guerrillas and civic leaders of World War II
History snapshot	La Union was created in 1850 from towns of Ilocos Sur, Pangasinan, and Benguet, making cultural blending part of its identity. Coastal trade and modern surfing now coexist with farming and weaving traditions.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; palo-sebo; kadang-kadang; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments, guitar, bandurria, bamboo flute, drums, and town brass bands
Music and oral traditions	dallot improvised verse, dung-aw lament, Ilocano folk songs such as Pamulinawen and Manang Biday, and Pangasinan coastal songs
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Pangasinan in southern areas; Kankanaey/Ibaloy in uplands; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Ilocano social dances; manang biday dance interpretations; coastal festival dances
Retrieval aliases	La Union; Region I (Ilocos Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Pangasinan

Record ID: PH-0105500000 | PSGC: 0105500000 | Region: Region I (Ilocos Region) | 2024 population: 3,188,540

Pangasinan reflects the traditions of Pangasinan, Ilocano, Bolinao and Sambal communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Pangasinan, Ilocano, Bolinao and Sambal communities
Festivals and festivities	Bangus Festival; Pista'y Dayat; Pistay Dayat sea celebrations
Food and culinary culture	bangus; puto Calasiao; bagoong; pigar-pigar; tupig
Historical and cultural places	Lingayen Gulf war memorials; Manaoag Church; Bolinao Church; Hundred Islands cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Juan de la Cruz Palaris; Victorio Edades; Princess Urduja as a legendary figure
History snapshot	Pangasinan developed around the Agno River and Lingayen Gulf and is linked to the precolonial polity of Caboloan. The Palaris Revolt of 1762-1765 was one of the largest anti-colonial uprisings in northern Luzon.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; palo-sebo; kadang-kadang; coastal boat races; boat races; sipa; sungka; fishing contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla instruments, guitar, bandurria, bamboo flute, drums, and town brass bands; rondalla; drums; bamboo flute
Music and oral traditions	dallot improvised verse, dung-aw lament, Ilocano folk songs such as Pamulinawen and Manang Biday, and Pangasinan coastal songs; Pangasinan folk songs and oral narratives
Languages and speech varieties	Pangasinan; Ilocano; Bolinao; Sambal varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sayaw ed tapew na bangko; oasiwas; binoyugan; coastal pandanggo
Retrieval aliases	Pangasinan; Region I (Ilocos Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region II (Cagayan Valley)

PSGC region code: 0200000000 | 2024 population: 3,777,608 | Provinces: 5

A river-valley and island region where Ivatan, Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, Yogad, Ilocano, Bugkalot, Isinai, and Agta communities maintain varied agricultural, fishing, weaving, and oral traditions.

Cultural communities	Ivatan, Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, Yogad, Ilocano, Isinai, Bugkalot/Ilongot, Agta, and Kalanguya communities
Languages and speech varieties	Ivatan, Itbayaten, Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, Yogad, Ilocano, Isinai, Bugkalot, Agta languages, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; archery; boat races; harvest contests; palu-palo reenactment games in Batanes
Instruments and material culture	bamboo flutes and percussion, gongs in highland communities, guitar, rondalla instruments, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Ivatan laji and traditional songs; Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, and Ilocano folk songs; highland chants and oral narratives
Folk and ritual dances	palu-palo, Ivatan fundanggo forms, Gaddang and Ifugao-influenced dances, tayaw, and Ilocano social dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Batanes

Record ID: PH-0200900000 | PSGC: 0200900000 | Region: Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 2024 population: 18,937

Batanes reflects the traditions of Ivatan and Itbayaten communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ivatan and Itbayaten communities
Festivals and festivities	Vakul-Kanayi Festival; Palu-Palo Festival; Ivatans Day
Food and culinary culture	uvud balls; lunis; dibang flying fish; turmeric rice; root crops
Historical and cultural places	Ivatan stone houses in Savidug and Chavayan; San Carlos Borromeo Church; Dipnaysupuan Japanese Tunnel; old lighthouses
Heroes and notable figures	Aman Dangat; Ivatan boat builders and stone-house artisans; Pacita Abad
History snapshot	Ivatan communities developed stone architecture, wind-resistant farming, and seafaring adapted to the northern islands. Spanish authority was formally established in 1783, while Batan Island was among the first Philippine locations occupied by Japan in 1941.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; archery; boat races; harvest contests; palu-palo reenactment games in Batanes; palu-palo games; boat races; archery; stone-lifting contests
Instruments and material culture	bamboo flutes and percussion, gongs in highland communities, guitar, rondalla instruments, and drums; guitar; rondalla; bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Ivatan laji and traditional songs; Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, and Ilocano folk songs; highland chants and oral narratives; laji; Ivatan work and boat songs
Languages and speech varieties	Ivatan; Itbayaten; Isamurongen/Ibatan varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	palu-palo; fundanggo; Ivatan wedding and harvest dances
Retrieval aliases	Batanes; Region II (Cagayan Valley); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Cagayan

Record ID: PH-0201500000 | PSGC: 0201500000 | Region: Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 2024 population: 1,284,676

Cagayan reflects the traditions of Ibanag, Itawis, Malaweg, Ilocano and Agta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ibanag, Itawis, Malaweg, Ilocano and Agta communities
Festivals and festivities	Pavvurulun Afi Festival; Aggao Nac Cagayan; Sambali Festival
Food and culinary culture	pancit batil patung; carabao chicharon; tupig; sinanta
Historical and cultural places	Callao Cave; Lal-lo/Nueva Segovia heritage; Iguig Calvary Hills; Cape Engaño Lighthouse on Palaui
Heroes and notable figures	Ibanag and Itawis local leaders; regional writers and church figures; community defenders during colonial and wartime periods
History snapshot	Cagayan was organized as a Spanish province in 1583 and became a center of the tobacco monopoly. The Cagayan River shaped settlement, trade, agriculture, and the multilingual culture of the valley.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; archery; boat races; harvest contests; palu-palo reenactment games in Batanes
Instruments and material culture	bamboo flutes and percussion, gongs in highland communities, guitar, rondalla instruments, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Ivatan laji and traditional songs; Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, and Ilocano folk songs; highland chants and oral narratives
Languages and speech varieties	Ibanag; Itawis; Malaweg; Ilocano; Gaddang; Agta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Ibanag and Itawis festival dances; Gaddang dances; Ilocano social dances
Retrieval aliases	Cagayan; Region II (Cagayan Valley); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Isabela

Record ID: PH-0203100000 | PSGC: 0203100000 | Region: Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 2024 population: 1,733,048

Isabela reflects the traditions of Ilocano, Ibanag, Gaddang, Yogad and Agta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ilocano, Ibanag, Gaddang, Yogad and Agta communities
Festivals and festivities	Bambanti Festival; Gawagaway-yan Festival; Balatong Festival
Food and culinary culture	pancit Cabagan; binallay; moriecos; corn and rice products
Historical and cultural places	Palanan capture site of Emilio Aguinaldo; San Pablo Church ruins; Isabela Museum and Library; Northern Sierra Madre cultural landscapes
Heroes and notable figures	Emilio Aguinaldo as an associated historical figure; Gaddang, Yogad and Ibanag cultural bearers
History snapshot	Created in 1856 from parts of Cagayan and Nueva Vizcaya and named for Queen Isabella II, the province later became a major grain and corn producer. Palanan is nationally significant as the place where Emilio Aguinaldo was captured in 1901.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; archery; boat races; harvest contests; palu-palo reenactment games in Batanes
Instruments and material culture	bamboo flutes and percussion, gongs in highland communities, guitar, rondalla instruments, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Ivatan laji and traditional songs; Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, and Ilocano folk songs; highland chants and oral narratives
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Ibanag; Gaddang; Yogad; Tagalog; Agta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Gaddang dances; Ilocano occupational dances; Bambanti festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Isabela; Region II (Cagayan Valley); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Nueva Vizcaya

Record ID: PH-0205000000 | PSGC: 0205000000 | Region: Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 2024 population: 530,106

Nueva Vizcaya reflects the traditions of Gaddang, Isinai, Ilocano, Kalanguya, Ifugao and Bugkalot communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Gaddang, Isinai, Ilocano, Kalanguya, Ifugao and Bugkalot communities
Festivals and festivities	Ammungan Festival; Citrus Festival; Grand Ammungan
Food and culinary culture	citrus products; native rice cakes; coffee; mountain vegetables
Historical and cultural places	Dupax del Sur Church; Dalton Pass; Nueva Vizcaya Museum; Capisaan Cave cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Edith L. Tiempo; local Gaddang, Isinai, Kalanguya and Bugkalot leaders
History snapshot	The province was created in 1839 and served as a historic corridor between the Cagayan Valley and Cordillera. Its modern identity is explicitly multiethnic, celebrated through the Ammungan or gathering of peoples.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; archery; boat races; harvest contests; palu-palo reenactment games in Batanes
Instruments and material culture	bamboo flutes and percussion, gongs in highland communities, guitar, rondalla instruments, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Ivatan laji and traditional songs; Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, and Ilocano folk songs; highland chants and oral narratives
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Gaddang; Isinai; Kalanguya; Bugkalot; Ifugao languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Gaddang and Isinai dances; tayaw; bendian; Ammungan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Nueva Vizcaya; Region II (Cagayan Valley); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Quirino

Record ID: PH-0205700000 | PSGC: 0205700000 | Region: Region II (Cagayan Valley) | 2024 population: 210,841

Quirino reflects the traditions of Ilocano, Ifugao, Bugkalot and Tagalog communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ilocano, Ifugao, Bugkalot and Tagalog communities
Festivals and festivities	Panagdadapun Festival; Quirino Motorismo; town fiestas
Food and culinary culture	citrus products; corn coffee; native rice cakes; forest honey
Historical and cultural places	Aglipay Caves; Governor’s Rapids; Nagtipunan cultural landscapes; Landingan Viewpoint
Heroes and notable figures	Bugkalot elders and community leaders; provincial pioneers and forest defenders
History snapshot	Quirino began as a subprovince of Nueva Vizcaya and became a separate province in 1971. Its cultural identity combines Ilocano settlement, Ifugao and Bugkalot traditions, river travel, and forest-based livelihoods.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; archery; boat races; harvest contests; palu-palo reenactment games in Batanes
Instruments and material culture	bamboo flutes and percussion, gongs in highland communities, guitar, rondalla instruments, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Ivatan laji and traditional songs; Ibanag, Itawis, Gaddang, and Ilocano folk songs; highland chants and oral narratives
Languages and speech varieties	Ilocano; Ifugao varieties; Bugkalot/Ilongot; Tagalog; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Bugkalot and Ifugao dances; tayaw; Ilocano festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Quirino; Region II (Cagayan Valley); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region III (Central Luzon)

PSGC region code: 0300000000 | 2024 population: 12,989,074 | Provinces: 7

A central plain and coastal region shaped by Tagalog, Kapampangan, Sambal, Pangasinan, Ilocano, and Aeta cultures. It is strongly associated with rice farming, river and coastal livelihoods, religious theater, revolutionary history, and town brass bands.

Cultural communities	Tagalog, Kapampangan, Sambal, Pangasinan, Ilocano, and Aeta communities
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog, Kapampangan, Sambal languages, Ilocano, Pangasinan, several Aeta languages, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs
Folk and ritual dances	kuraldal, sayaw sa Obando, maglalatik-influenced school repertoire, Aeta talek, karakol, and local festival dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Bataan

Record ID: PH-0300800000 | PSGC: 0300800000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 891,440

Bataan reflects the traditions of Tagalog and Kapampangan communities with Sambal and Aeta presence. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog and Kapampangan communities with Sambal and Aeta presence
Festivals and festivities	Pawikan Festival; Araw ng Kagitingan commemorations; Banga Festival
Food and culinary culture	tinapa; cashew products; Mariveles suman; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Mt. Samat National Shrine; Death March markers; Abucay Church; Las Casas Filipinas de Acuzar
Heroes and notable figures	Tomas Pinpin; Cayetano Arellano; World War II soldiers and civilians of Bataan
History snapshot	Bataan was an early printing center and later became one of the central battlefields of World War II. The 1942 defense of Bataan and the Death March remain defining national memories.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Kapampangan; Sambal in some areas; Aeta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	wartime commemorative dances; Tagalog fiesta dances; Aeta talek
Retrieval aliases	Bataan; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Bulacan

Record ID: PH-0301400000 | PSGC: 0301400000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 3,876,806

Bulacan reflects the traditions of Tagalog and Kapampangan communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog and Kapampangan communities
Festivals and festivities	Singkaban Festival; Obando Fertility Rites; Kneeling Carabao Festival
Food and culinary culture	pastillas de leche; inipit; ensaymada de Malolos; chicharon; minasa
Historical and cultural places	Barasoain Church; Biak-na-Bato; Marcelo H. del Pilar Shrine; Casa Real de Malolos
Heroes and notable figures	Marcelo H. del Pilar; Gregorio del Pilar; Francisco Balagtas; Trinidad Tecson; Pio Valenzuela
History snapshot	Bulacan was a major center of the Revolution and the First Philippine Republic. Malolos hosted the 1898 Congress and the inauguration of the republic in 1899.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; carabao games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars; rondalla; brass bands; bamboo instruments
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs; kundiman, sarsuwela, pasyon and balagtasán traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Kapampangan in western and northern areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sayaw sa Obando; singkaban festival dances; Tagalog folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Bulacan; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Nueva Ecija

Record ID: PH-0304900000 | PSGC: 0304900000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 2,395,816

Nueva Ecija reflects the traditions of Tagalog, Ilocano, Kapampangan and Pangasinan communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog, Ilocano, Kapampangan and Pangasinan communities
Festivals and festivities	Taong Putik Festival; Nueva Ecija Rice Festival; Tanduyong Festival
Food and culinary culture	batutay longganisa; kesong puti; rice cakes; carabao-milk products
Historical and cultural places	Camp Pangatian Memorial Shrine; Minalungao; Gabaldon heritage schools; old Gapan and Cabanatuan sites
Heroes and notable figures	Mariano Llanera; Manuel Tinio; Epifanio de los Santos
History snapshot	Nueva Ecija became a major agricultural frontier and is widely known as the rice granary of the country. The 1896 Cry of Nueva Ecija and later guerrilla resistance gave it a prominent revolutionary and wartime history.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Ilocano; Kapampangan; Pangasinan; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	taong putik ritual performance; farming and harvest dances; Tagalog/Ilocano social dances
Retrieval aliases	Nueva Ecija; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Pampanga

Record ID: PH-0305400000 | PSGC: 0305400000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 2,586,446

Pampanga reflects the traditions of Kapampangan communities with Tagalog and Aeta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Kapampangan communities with Tagalog and Aeta communities
Festivals and festivities	Giant Lantern Festival; Sisig Festival; Sinukwan Festival; Kuraldal
Food and culinary culture	sisig; bringhe; tocino; tibok-tibok; buro
Historical and cultural places	San Guillermo Church; Pamintuan Mansion; Museo ning Angeles; old San Fernando railway station
Heroes and notable figures	Jose Abad Santos; Vicente Manansala; Diosdado Macapagal; Luis Taruc
History snapshot	Pampanga was established as one of the earliest Spanish provinces in 1571. Its long history includes river trade, agricultural estates, religious arts, wartime resistance, and a nationally influential culinary tradition.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars; brass bands; rondalla; drums; bamboo instruments
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs; pulosa; Atin Cu Pung Singsing; pasyon and town-band music
Languages and speech varieties	Kapampangan; Tagalog; Sambal and Aeta languages in some areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kuraldal; sinukwan festival dances; Aeta talek; Kapampangan folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Pampanga; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Tarlac

Record ID: PH-0306900000 | PSGC: 0306900000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 1,568,162

Tarlac reflects the traditions of Kapampangan, Pangasinan, Ilocano, Tagalog and Aeta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Kapampangan, Pangasinan, Ilocano, Tagalog and Aeta communities
Festivals and festivities	Malatarlak Festival; Belenismo sa Tarlac; Chicharon-Iniruban Festival
Food and culinary culture	tupig; Camiling chicharon; iniruban; native rice cakes
Historical and cultural places	Capas National Shrine; Aquino Center; Monasterio de Tarlac; old Camiling heritage sites
Heroes and notable figures	Francisco Makabulos; Benigno Aquino Jr.; Carlos P. Romulo
History snapshot	Created as a province in 1872, Tarlac developed as a meeting ground of several lowland languages and Aeta communities. It was a revolutionary stronghold and later the endpoint of the Bataan Death March at Camp O'Donnell.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs
Languages and speech varieties	Kapampangan; Pangasinan; Ilocano; Tagalog; Aeta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Malatarlak street dances; Aeta talek; Kapampangan, Pangasinan and Ilocano dances
Retrieval aliases	Tarlac; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Zambales

Record ID: PH-0307100000 | PSGC: 0307100000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 681,225

Zambales reflects the traditions of Sambal, Ilocano, Tagalog and Aeta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Sambal, Ilocano, Tagalog and Aeta communities
Festivals and festivities	Dinamulag Mango Festival; Paynauen Duyan Festival; Subic festivals
Food and culinary culture	sweet mangoes; cashew; seafood; bagoong
Historical and cultural places	Capones Lighthouse; Casa San Miguel; Subic naval heritage sites; Aeta ancestral-domain communities
Heroes and notable figures	Ramon Magsaysay; Sambal and Aeta community leaders
History snapshot	Zambales is a Sambal homeland with a long mining, fishing, and maritime history. The Subic Bay area became a major naval center, while the 1991 Pinatubo eruption reshaped communities and strengthened Aeta cultural advocacy.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs
Languages and speech varieties	Sambal languages; Ilocano; Tagalog; Aeta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Sambal harvest and war dances; Aeta talek; mango festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Zambales; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Aurora

Record ID: PH-0307700000 | PSGC: 0307700000 | Region: Region III (Central Luzon) | 2024 population: 240,824

Aurora reflects the traditions of Tagalog, Ilocano, Kasiguranin, Dumagat and Alta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog, Ilocano, Kasiguranin, Dumagat and Alta communities
Festivals and festivities	Sabutan Festival; Aurora Day; Baler Surfing events
Food and culinary culture	pako salad; suman de Baler; coco jam; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Museo de Baler; Quezon House; Baler Church; Ermita Hill; old Spanish and American sites
Heroes and notable figures	Manuel L. Quezon; Doña Aurora Aragon-Quezon; Dumagat and Alta cultural bearers
History snapshot	Aurora was formerly a subprovince and later part of Quezon before becoming an independent province in 1979. Baler is associated with the Siege of Baler and with President Manuel L. Quezon.
Games and recreation	arnis; sipa; sungka; piko; palo-sebo; carabao and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, brass-band instruments, bamboo instruments, drums, and guitars
Music and oral traditions	pasyon chanting, kundiman, Kapampangan pulosa, awit and corrido, brass-band music, and farming songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Ilocano; Kasiguranin; Umiray Dumaget Agta; Alta; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Dumagat ritual dances; Tagalog and Ilocano fiesta dances; sabutan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Aurora; Region III (Central Luzon); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region IV-A (CALABARZON)

PSGC region code: 0400000000 | 2024 population: 16,933,234 | Provinces: 5

A predominantly Tagalog region with major revolutionary sites, lakeshore and coastal settlements, woodcarving and embroidery centers, devotional processions, strong culinary traditions, and a large body of Tagalog music and dance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog communities, Dumagat/Remontado and Agta communities, and urban migrant populations
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog varieties, Filipino, English, Chavacano de Cavite/Ternate, and Dumagat/Agta languages in upland areas
Games and recreation	arnis; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; karera ng bangka; piko and patintero
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, bandurria, guitar, bamboo percussion, drums used for subli and processions, and town bands
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, kumintang, subli chants, awit and corrido, processional music, and Tagalog folk songs
Folk and ritual dances	subli, maglalatik, karakol, mardicas, gigantes festival dances, pandanggo, and rigodon forms

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Batangas

Record ID: PH-0401000000 | PSGC: 0401000000 | Region: Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 2024 population: 2,994,795

Batangas reflects the traditions of Batangueño Tagalog communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Batangueño Tagalog communities
Festivals and festivities	Sublian Festival; Ala Eh Festival; Parada ng Lechon
Food and culinary culture	lomi; bulalo; kapeng barako; sinaing na tulingan; panutsa
Historical and cultural places	Taal Heritage Town and Basilica; Mabini Shrine; Malvar Shrine; Marcela Agoncillo ancestral house
Heroes and notable figures	Apolinario Mabini; Miguel Malvar; Marcela Agoncillo; Felipe Agoncillo
History snapshot	Batangas was a major Tagalog trading and agricultural area and became one of the most active provinces in the Revolution. The Batangas War during the Philippine-American War left a deep local memory of resistance and civilian hardship.
Games and recreation	arnis; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; karera ng bangka; piko and patintero; arnis; sungka; boat races; palo-sebo
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, bandurria, guitar, bamboo percussion, drums used for subli and processions, and town bands; drums for subli; rondalla; guitar; brass bands
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, kumintang, subli chants, awit and corrido, processional music, and Tagalog folk songs; kumintang; subli chants; kundiman
Languages and speech varieties	Batangueño Tagalog varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	subli; kumintang-related dances; karakol; rural Tagalog dances
Retrieval aliases	Batangas; Region IV-A (CALABARZON); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Cavite

Record ID: PH-0402100000 | PSGC: 0402100000 | Region: Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 2024 population: 4,573,884

Cavite reflects the traditions of Tagalog communities with Caviteño and Ternateño Chavacano heritage. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog communities with Caviteño and Ternateño Chavacano heritage
Festivals and festivities	Regada Festival; Wagayway Festival; Kalayaan Festival; Mardicas Festival
Food and culinary culture	bibingko; pancit pusit; tamales; bacalao; quesillo
Historical and cultural places	Aguinaldo Shrine; Bonifacio Trial House; Corregidor Island; Tejeros Convention Site
Heroes and notable figures	Emilio Aguinaldo; Mariano Alvarez; Baldomero Aguinaldo; Mariano Gómez
History snapshot	Cavite was the site of the 1872 mutiny and a central theater of the 1896 Revolution. Independence was proclaimed in Kawit on 12 June 1898, making the province foundational to republican history.
Games and recreation	arnis; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; karera ng bangka; piko and patintero
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, bandurria, guitar, bamboo percussion, drums used for subli and processions, and town bands
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, kumintang, subli chants, awit and corrido, processional music, and Tagalog folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog/Caviteño; Chavacano de Cavite and Ternate; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	mardicas; karakol; regada street dances; Tagalog fiesta dances
Retrieval aliases	Cavite; Region IV-A (CALABARZON); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Laguna

Record ID: PH-0403400000 | PSGC: 0403400000 | Region: Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 2024 population: 3,687,345

Laguna reflects the traditions of Tagalog lakeshore and upland communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog lakeshore and upland communities
Festivals and festivities	Anilag Festival; Turumba Festival; Pila Heritage festivals
Food and culinary culture	buko pie; espasol; kesong puti; uraro; puto Biñan
Historical and cultural places	Rizal Shrine in Calamba; Pila heritage town; Nagcarlan Underground Cemetery; Paete Church
Heroes and notable figures	José Rizal; Pedro Pelaez; Paete woodcarvers and artists
History snapshot	Laguna's towns grew around Laguna de Bay, river routes, agriculture, crafts, and pilgrimage. Calamba is the birthplace of José Rizal, while Pila, Paete, Pakil, and Nagcarlan preserve major Tagalog heritage traditions.
Games and recreation	arnis; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; karera ng bangka; piko and patintero; sungka; piko; sipa; boat races
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, bandurria, guitar, bamboo percussion, drums used for subli and processions, and town bands; rondalla; wood and bamboo percussion; town bands
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, kumintang, subli chants, awit and corrido, processional music, and Tagalog folk songs; kundiman; awit; religious processional music
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	maglalatik; turumba-related processional dances; Tagalog folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Laguna; Region IV-A (CALABARZON); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Quezon

Record ID: PH-0405600000 | PSGC: 0405600000 | Region: Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 2024 population: 1,980,338

Quezon reflects the traditions of Tayabasin and other Tagalog communities with Agta groups. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tayabasin and other Tagalog communities with Agta groups
Festivals and festivities	Pahiyas Festival; Niyogyugan Festival; Mayohan sa Tayabas
Food and culinary culture	pancit habhab; Lucban longganisa; budin; lambanog; kiping
Historical and cultural places	Tayabas Basilica and Casa Comunidad; Malagonlong Bridge; Lucban Church; Hermano Pule sites
Heroes and notable figures	Apolinario de la Cruz (Hermano Pule); Claro M. Recto; local resistance leaders
History snapshot	Formerly known as Tayabas, the province was renamed Quezon in 1946. It is associated with Hermano Pule's religious movement, coconut agriculture, pilgrimage, and the colorful harvest traditions of Lucban and Tayabas.
Games and recreation	arnis; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; karera ng bangka; piko and patintero
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, bandurria, guitar, bamboo percussion, drums used for subli and processions, and town bands
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, kumintang, subli chants, awit and corrido, processional music, and Tagalog folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tayabas Tagalog and other Tagalog varieties; Bikol in eastern border areas; Agta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pahiyas festival dances; karakol; Tagalog harvest and processional dances
Retrieval aliases	Quezon; Region IV-A (CALABARZON); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Rizal

Record ID: PH-0405800000 | PSGC: 0405800000 | Region: Region IV-A (CALABARZON) | 2024 population: 3,416,541

Rizal reflects the traditions of Tagalog communities and Dumagat/Remontado communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tagalog communities and Dumagat/Remontado communities
Festivals and festivities	Higantes Festival; Sumakah Festival; Maytime festivals
Food and culinary culture	suman; kasoy; bibingka; kakanin; freshwater fish dishes
Historical and cultural places	Angono Petroglyphs; Juan Sumulong Memorial Shrine; Botong Francisco heritage sites; Hinulugang Taktak
Heroes and notable figures	Juan Sumulong; Carlos “Botong” Francisco; Lucio San Pedro
History snapshot	Created in 1901 from the old district of Morong and parts of Manila Province, Rizal was named for José Rizal. Angono developed as a major center of visual art, music, folk ritual, and prehistoric heritage.
Games and recreation	arnis; sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; karera ng bangka; piko and patintero
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, bandurria, guitar, bamboo percussion, drums used for subli and processions, and town bands; rondalla; brass bands; percussion; bamboo instruments
Music and oral traditions	kundiman, kumintang, subli chants, awit and corrido, processional music, and Tagalog folk songs; kundiman; orchestral and band music associated with Lucio San Pedro; folk chants
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Filipino; English; Dumagat/Remontado languages in upland areas
Folk and ritual dances	higantes festival dance; karakol; Angono folk and processional dances
Retrieval aliases	Rizal; Region IV-A (CALABARZON); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

MIMAROPA Region

PSGC region code: 1700000000 | 2024 population: 3,245,446 | Provinces: 5

An island region with Tagalog, Mangyan, Cuyonon, Palawano, Tagbanwa, Batak, Molbog, Romblomanon, Asi, Onhan, and maritime communities. Its culture includes boatbuilding, weaving, epic and poetic traditions, ritual music, fishing, and island trade.

Cultural communities	Mangyan groups, Tagbanwa, Palawano, Cuyonon, Batak, Molbog, Romblomanon, Asi/Bantoanon, Onhan, and Tagalog communities
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog and Marinduque varieties; Iraya, Alangan, Tadyawan, Tawbuid, Buhid, Hanunoo, Ratagnon; Cuyonon, Palawano, Tagbanwa, Batak, Molbog, Kagayanen; Romblomanon, Asi, Onhan, and Hiligaynon
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; archery; fishing contests; stilt and coconut games
Instruments and material culture	gitgit bowed lute, kudyapi/kusyapi lute, basal gongs, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and rondalla instruments
Music and oral traditions	Mangyan ambahan, Palawan kulilal and tultul, Cuyonon songs, Tagbanwa ritual music, and island folk songs
Folk and ritual dances	pandanggo sa ilaw, sayaw sa Cuyo, karatong, Mangyan ritual dances, Tagbanwa dances, biniray and island festival dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Marinduque

Record ID: PH-1704000000 | PSGC: 1704000000 | Region: MIMAROPA Region | 2024 population: 226,522

Marinduque reflects the traditions of Marinduque Tagalog communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Marinduque Tagalog communities
Festivals and festivities	Moriones Festival; Bila-Bila Festival; Putong celebrations
Food and culinary culture	arrowroot/uraro cookies; bibingkang lalaki; adobo sa gata; ulang-ulang
Historical and cultural places	Boac Cathedral; Battle of Pulang Lupa site; old Boac heritage houses; Casa de Don Emilio
Heroes and notable figures	Marinduque revolutionaries and Pulang Lupa fighters; putong tradition bearers
History snapshot	Marinduque was a strategic island province during the Philippine-American War, especially at the Battle of Pulang Lupa in 1900. Its Holy Week Moriones and putong welcome ritual are major cultural identifiers.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; archery; fishing contests; stilt and coconut games
Instruments and material culture	gitgit bowed lute, kudyapi/kusyapi lute, basal gongs, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and rondalla instruments
Music and oral traditions	Mangyan ambahan, Palawan kulilal and tultul, Cuyonon songs, Tagbanwa ritual music, and island folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Marinduque Tagalog varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Moriones performance; putong/tubong ritual; pandanggo and Tagalog social dances
Retrieval aliases	Marinduque; MIMAROPA Region; Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Occidental Mindoro

Record ID: PH-1705100000 | PSGC: 1705100000 | Region: MIMAROPA Region | 2024 population: 511,417

Occidental Mindoro reflects the traditions of Tawbuid, Ratagnon, Hanunoo, Buhid, Iraya and Tagalog communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tawbuid, Ratagnon, Hanunoo, Buhid, Iraya and Tagalog communities
Festivals and festivities	Apo Iraya Festival; Pandang Gitab; town fiestas
Food and culinary culture	pakumbo; cashew products; seafood; rice and root-crop dishes
Historical and cultural places	Apo Reef cultural seascape; Mangyan ancestral communities; Mamburao heritage sites; Sablayan and Pandan landscapes
Heroes and notable figures	Mangyan elders, poets, weavers and ancestral-domain advocates
History snapshot	Mindoro was divided into Occidental and Oriental Mindoro in 1950. The western province combines coastal Tagalog settlements with several Mangyan cultural communities and major marine protected areas.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; archery; fishing contests; stilt and coconut games; boat races; archery; sungka; fishing contests
Instruments and material culture	gitgit bowed lute, kudyapi/kusyapi lute, basal gongs, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and rondalla instruments; gitgit; bamboo flutes and zithers; drums; gongs
Music and oral traditions	Mangyan ambahan, Palawan kulilal and tultul, Cuyonon songs, Tagbanwa ritual music, and island folk songs; ambahan in Mangyan communities; boat and work songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Tawbuid; Ratagnon; Hanunoo; Buhid; Iraya; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Mangyan ritual dances; pandanggo sa ilaw; coastal festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Occidental Mindoro; MIMAROPA Region; Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Oriental Mindoro

Record ID: PH-1705200000 | PSGC: 1705200000 | Region: MIMAROPA Region | 2024 population: 919,504

Oriental Mindoro reflects the traditions of Iraya, Alangan, Tadyawan, Bangon, Buhid, Hanunoo and Tagalog communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Iraya, Alangan, Tadyawan, Bangon, Buhid, Hanunoo and Tagalog communities
Festivals and festivities	Sanduguan Festival; Bahaghari Festival; Pandang Gitab
Food and culinary culture	suman sa lihiya; kalamay; banana chips; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Mangyan Heritage Center; Calapan Cathedral; Puerto Galera cultural landscape; Mangyan settlements
Heroes and notable figures	Ginaw Bilog; Hanunoo Mangyan poets and script bearers; N.V.M. Gonzalez as a Mindoro-associated writer
History snapshot	The eastern half of Mindoro became a separate province in 1950. It is a major center of Mangyan heritage, including ambahan poetry and Indigenous scripts, alongside Tagalog coastal settlements and historic maritime trade.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; archery; fishing contests; stilt and coconut games
Instruments and material culture	gitgit bowed lute, kudyapi/kusyapi lute, basal gongs, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and rondalla instruments; gitgit; bamboo instruments; gong and drum ensembles
Music and oral traditions	Mangyan ambahan, Palawan kulilal and tultul, Cuyonon songs, Tagbanwa ritual music, and island folk songs; ambahan; Mangyan chant traditions; Tagalog folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Tagalog; Iraya; Alangan; Tadyawan; Bangon; Buhid; Hanunoo; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pandanggo sa ilaw; Mangyan ritual dances; sanduguan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Oriental Mindoro; MIMAROPA Region; Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Palawan

Record ID: PH-1705300000 | PSGC: 1705300000 | Region: MIMAROPA Region | 2024 population: 968,795

Palawan reflects the traditions of Cuyonon, Palawano, Tagbanwa, Batak, Molbog, Kagayanen and migrant communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cuyonon, Palawano, Tagbanwa, Batak, Molbog, Kagayanen and migrant communities
Festivals and festivities	Baragatan Festival; Kulambo Festival; Pista y ang Kagueban
Food and culinary culture	tamilok; crocodile sisig; seafood; cashew products
Historical and cultural places	Tabon Caves; Plaza Cuartel; Cuyo Fort and Church; Palawan Museum; Tagbanwa cultural landscapes
Heroes and notable figures	Masino Intaray; Higinio Mendoza Sr.; Tagbanwa and Palawano cultural bearers
History snapshot	Palawan has some of the country’s most important archaeological evidence at Tabon Caves and a long history of island trade. World War II memory includes the Palawan Massacre, while Cuyo and Indigenous communities preserve strong musical and ritual traditions.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; archery; fishing contests; stilt and coconut games; boat races; archery; fishing contests; sungka
Instruments and material culture	gitgit bowed lute, kudyapi/kusyapi lute, basal gongs, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and rondalla instruments; kusyapi/kudyapi; basal gongs; bamboo flute; drums
Music and oral traditions	Mangyan ambahan, Palawan kulilal and tultul, Cuyonon songs, Tagbanwa ritual music, and island folk songs; kulilal and tultul; Cuyonon songs; Tagbanwa chants
Languages and speech varieties	Cuyonon; Palawano languages; Tagbanwa languages; Batak; Molbog; Kagayanen; Hiligaynon; Tagalog; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sayaw sa Cuyo; karatong; Tagbanwa ritual dances; Palawano dances
Retrieval aliases	Palawan; MIMAROPA Region; Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Romblon

Record ID: PH-1705900000 | PSGC: 1705900000 | Region: MIMAROPA Region | 2024 population: 302,824

Romblon reflects the traditions of Romblomanon, Asi/Bantoanon and Onhan communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Romblomanon, Asi/Bantoanon and Onhan communities
Festivals and festivities	Biniray Festival; Marble Festival; Saginyogan Festival
Food and culinary culture	sarsa; seafood; native rice cakes; peanut brittle
Historical and cultural places	Fort San Andres; Romblon Cathedral; Banton archaeological sites; marble quarries and workshops
Heroes and notable figures	N.V.M. Gonzalez; Banton textile and weaving tradition bearers
History snapshot	Romblon's islands have long been connected by maritime trade. The province is known for marble, the archaeological and textile heritage of Banton, and the coexistence of Romblomanon, Asi, and Onhan languages.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; archery; fishing contests; stilt and coconut games
Instruments and material culture	gitgit bowed lute, kudyapi/kusyapi lute, basal gongs, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and rondalla instruments
Music and oral traditions	Mangyan ambahan, Palawan kulilal and tultul, Cuyonon songs, Tagbanwa ritual music, and island folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Romblomanon; Asi/Bantoanon; Onhan; Hiligaynon; Tagalog; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	biniray festival dances; Asi and Onhan folk dances; island pandanggo
Retrieval aliases	Romblon; MIMAROPA Region; Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region V (Bicol Region)

PSGC region code: 0500000000 | 2024 population: 6,064,426 | Provinces: 6

A Bikol-speaking region known for devotion to Our Lady of Peñafrancia, abaca and coconut industries, volcanic landscapes, fishing, epic traditions linked to Ibalong, and expressive song, poetry, and dance.

Cultural communities	Central Bikol, Rinconada, Partido, Albay, Catanduanes, Masbateño, Sorsoganon, Agta, and seafaring communities
Languages and speech varieties	Central Bikol, Rinconada Bikol, Partido Bikol, Albay Bikol varieties, Catanduanes Bikol varieties, Masbateño, Sorsogon Bikol, Waray Sorsogon, Manide and other Agta languages, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music
Folk and ritual dances	pantomina, lapay bantigue, jota and pastores forms, Ibalong festival dances, and local harvest dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Albay

Record ID: PH-0500500000 | PSGC: 0500500000 | Region: Region V (Bicol Region) | 2024 population: 1,379,398

Albay reflects the traditions of Central Bikol and Albay Bikol communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Central Bikol and Albay Bikol communities
Festivals and festivities	Magayon Festival; Ibalong Festival; Cagsawa Festival
Food and culinary culture	Bicol Express; pinangat; laing; sili ice cream; pili products
Historical and cultural places	Cagsawa Ruins; Daraga Church; Japanese tunnels; Mayon cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Simeon Ola; Potenciano Gregorio; Bikol epic and oral-tradition bearers
History snapshot	Albay developed around Mayon Volcano and Spanish-era towns. The 1814 eruption that buried Cagsawa became a defining historical memory, while the Ibalong epic and Sarung Banggi remain cultural touchstones.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion; rondalla; guitar; drums; bamboo flute
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music; Sarung Banggi; Ibalong performance music; rawit-dawit
Languages and speech varieties	Central Bikol; Albay Bikol varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pantomina; Ibalong festival dances; pastores and harvest dances
Retrieval aliases	Albay; Region V (Bicol Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Camarines Norte

Record ID: PH-0501600000 | PSGC: 0501600000 | Region: Region V (Bicol Region) | 2024 population: 604,666

Camarines Norte reflects the traditions of Bikol, Tagalog and Manide/Agta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Bikol, Tagalog and Manide/Agta communities
Festivals and festivities	Bantayog Festival; Pinyasan Festival; Busig-on Festival
Food and culinary culture	pili products; kinunot; laing; pineapple products
Historical and cultural places	First Rizal Monument in Daet; Vinzons ancestral sites; Paracale mining heritage; old churches
Heroes and notable figures	Wenceslao Vinzons; José Maria Panganiban
History snapshot	The province has a long gold-mining and coastal history. Daet erected the country's first monument to José Rizal in 1898, while Wenceslao Vinzons became a leading anti-Japanese resistance figure.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music
Languages and speech varieties	Central Bikol; Tagalog; Manide and other Agta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pantomina; jota Camarines; pinyasan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Camarines Norte; Region V (Bicol Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Camarines Sur

Record ID: PH-0501700000 | PSGC: 0501700000 | Region: Region V (Bicol Region) | 2024 population: 2,063,314

Camarines Sur reflects the traditions of Central Bikol, Rinconada, Partido, Buhi and Agta communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Central Bikol, Rinconada, Partido, Buhi and Agta communities
Festivals and festivities	Kaogma Festival; Peñafrancia Festival; Voyadores Festival
Food and culinary culture	laing; kinalas; pili tart; pancit bato
Historical and cultural places	Naga Cathedral and Basilica; Peñafrancia Museum; old Camaligan Church; Caramoan cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Tomas Arejola; Jesse Robredo; Peñafrancia tradition bearers
History snapshot	Camarines Sur grew from the historic province of Ambos Camarines. Naga became the religious center of the Peñafrancia devotion, while the province’s linguistic diversity reflects several distinct Bikol language zones.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music
Languages and speech varieties	Central Bikol; Rinconada Bikol; Partido Bikol; Buhi and other Albay Bikol varieties; Agta languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pantomina; voyadores festival dance; Bikol courtship and harvest dances
Retrieval aliases	Camarines Sur; Region V (Bicol Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Catanduanes

Record ID: PH-0502000000 | PSGC: 0502000000 | Region: Region V (Bicol Region) | 2024 population: 261,169

Catanduanes reflects the traditions of Catanduanes Bikol communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Catanduanes Bikol communities
Festivals and festivities	Catandungan Festival; Abaca Festival; Padadyaw sa Tinampo
Food and culinary culture	tinuktok; latik; pili products; seafood; abaca-based products
Historical and cultural places	Bato Church; Museo de Catanduanes; Luyang Cave; old lighthouses and abaca towns
Heroes and notable figures	Catandunganon wartime guerrillas; abaca farmers, weavers and folk artists
History snapshot	Catanduanes became a separate island province in 1945 after being part of Albay. Its history is shaped by abaca, seafaring, typhoons, and strong island-wide Bikol traditions.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music
Languages and speech varieties	Catanduanes Bikol varieties; Central Bikol; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pantomina; abaca festival dances; island harvest dances
Retrieval aliases	Catanduanes; Region V (Bicol Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Masbate

Record ID: PH-0504100000 | PSGC: 0504100000 | Region: Region V (Bicol Region) | 2024 population: 910,813

Masbate reflects the traditions of Masbateño, Cebuano, Hiligaynon, Waray and Bikol communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Masbateño, Cebuano, Hiligaynon, Waray and Bikol communities
Festivals and festivities	Rodeo Masbateño; Lapay Bantigue Festival; Manggaranon Festival
Food and culinary culture	carmelado; beef dishes; seafood; native rice cakes
Historical and cultural places	Jintotolo Lighthouse; Masbate Cathedral; cattle-ranch landscapes; Buntod Reef cultural seascape
Heroes and notable figures	Masbateño ranchers and seafarers; Lapay Bantigue tradition bearers
History snapshot	Masbate occupies a central maritime position between Luzon and the Visayas. Its ranching culture, mixed languages, and Lapay Bantigue dance reflect centuries of inter-island movement and exchange.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate; rodeo riding events; lasso contests; boat races; sungka
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion; guitar; rondalla; drums; ranch bells
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music; Masbateño songs and Visayan/Bikol folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Masbateño; Cebuano; Hiligaynon; Waray; Bikol; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	lapay bantigue; rodeo festival dances; coastal folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Masbate; Region V (Bicol Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Sorsogon

Record ID: PH-0506200000 | PSGC: 0506200000 | Region: Region V (Bicol Region) | 2024 population: 845,066

Sorsogon reflects the traditions of Sorsoganon Bikol, Waray Sorsogon and Central Bikol communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Sorsoganon Bikol, Waray Sorsogon and Central Bikol communities
Festivals and festivities	Kasanggayahan Festival; Pili Festival; Butanding Festival
Food and culinary culture	pili products; baluko; kinagang; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Barcelona Church ruins; Bulusan Church and Lake; Juban heritage houses; Donsol cultural seascape
Heroes and notable figures	Sorsoganon resistance leaders, seafarers, and folk artists; regional hero Simeon Ola
History snapshot	Sorsogon became a separate province in 1894. Its southern location created close cultural links with Samar, visible in its Bikol and Waray speech varieties, seafaring, and music.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; boat races; coconut and abaca contests; rodeo and riding events in Masbate
Instruments and material culture	rondalla, guitar, bamboo flute, drums, brass bands, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	Sarung Banggi, rawit-dawit and tigsik poetic forms, devotional hymns, Bikol folk songs, and Ibalong-related performance music
Languages and speech varieties	Sorsogon Bikol; Waray Sorsogon; Central Bikol; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pantomina; kasanggayahan dances; coastal and harvest dances
Retrieval aliases	Sorsogon; Region V (Bicol Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region VI (Western Visayas)

PSGC region code: 0600000000 | 2024 population: 4,861,911 | Provinces: 5

A Panay and Guimaras region shaped by Hiligaynon, Kinaray-a, Aklanon, Capiznon, Ati, and Panay Bukidnon communities. Its traditions include epic chanting, weaving, boatbuilding, seafood and sugar culture, and major devotional festivals.

Cultural communities	Hiligaynon, Kinaray-a, Aklanon, Capiznon, Ati, Panay Bukidnon/Suludnon, and island communities
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon, Kinaray-a, Aklanon, Malaynon, Capiznon, Caluyanon, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; kadang-kadang; boat races; palo-sebo; harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla and guitar, drums, bamboo instruments, and Panay Bukidnon gongs and percussion
Music and oral traditions	composo/komposo narrative songs, Panay Bukidnon sugidanon epics, Hiligaynon balitaw, devotional music, and festival drum ensembles
Folk and ritual dances	binanog, Ati-Atihan and Dinagyang street dances, Hiligaynon and Kinaray-a social dances, and festival-specific choreography

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Aklan

Record ID: PH-0600400000 | PSGC: 0600400000 | Region: Region VI (Western Visayas) | 2024 population: 634,422

Aklan reflects the traditions of Aklanon, Malaynon, Ati and Hiligaynon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Aklanon, Malaynon, Ati and Hiligaynon communities
Festivals and festivities	Ati-Atihan Festival; Piña and Fiber Festival; Bariw Festival
Food and culinary culture	inubarang manok; binakoe; latik; talaba and seafood
Historical and cultural places	Museo it Akean; Kalibo Cathedral; Ati-Atihan heritage routes; Motag Living Museum
Heroes and notable figures	General Francisco del Castillo; Victorino Mapa; Ati and Aklanon cultural bearers
History snapshot	Aklan was historically part of Capiz and became a separate province in 1956. The Ati-Atihan combines Catholic devotion with older local and Ati-linked performance traditions, while piña weaving is a major heritage craft.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; kadang-kadang; boat races; palo-sebo; harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla and guitar, drums, bamboo instruments, and Panay Bukidnon gongs and percussion; drums; bamboo instruments; rondalla; guitar
Music and oral traditions	composo/komposo narrative songs, Panay Bukidnon sugidanon epics, Hiligaynon balitaw, devotional music, and festival drum ensembles; Aklanon folk songs; festival drum music; composo
Languages and speech varieties	Aklanon; Malaynon; Hiligaynon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Ati-Atihan street dance; Aklanon folk dances; binanog in upland traditions
Retrieval aliases	Aklan; Region VI (Western Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Antique

Record ID: PH-0600600000 | PSGC: 0600600000 | Region: Region VI (Western Visayas) | 2024 population: 643,173

Antique reflects the traditions of Kinaray-a, Ati, Panay Bukidnon and Caluyanon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Kinaray-a, Ati, Panay Bukidnon and Caluyanon communities
Festivals and festivities	Binirayan Festival; Tiringbanay Festival; Patadyong Festival
Food and culinary culture	bandi; butong-butong; muscovado sweets; binabak
Historical and cultural places	Malandog marker; Evelio B. Javier Freedom Park; Anini-y Church; Patnongon ruins
Heroes and notable figures	Evelio B. Javier; Leandro Fullon; Kinaray-a and Panay Bukidnon tradition bearers
History snapshot	Antique occupies the western side of Panay and preserves strong Kinaray-a identity. The Binirayan festival recalls migration traditions, while the province is also associated with revolutionary leader Leandro Fullon and democracy martyr Evelio Javier.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; kadang-kadang; boat races; palo-sebo; harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla and guitar, drums, bamboo instruments, and Panay Bukidnon gongs and percussion; gongs and drums; bamboo instruments; rondalla
Music and oral traditions	composo/komposo narrative songs, Panay Bukidnon sugidanon epics, Hiligaynon balitaw, devotional music, and festival drum ensembles; komposo; sugidanon-linked traditions in Panay highlands
Languages and speech varieties	Kinaray-a; Caluyanon; Hiligaynon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	binanog; Kinaray-a folk dances; patadyong festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Antique; Region VI (Western Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Capiz

Record ID: PH-0601900000 | PSGC: 0601900000 | Region: Region VI (Western Visayas) | 2024 population: 835,098

Capiz reflects the traditions of Capiznon, Hiligaynon, Aklanon and Panay Bukidnon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Capiznon, Hiligaynon, Aklanon and Panay Bukidnon communities
Festivals and festivities	Capiztahan; Sinadya sa Halaran; Seafood Festival
Food and culinary culture	seafood; oysters; binakol; diwal shellfish
Historical and cultural places	Panay Church and bell; Manuel Roxas ancestral house; Ang Panublion Museum; Roxas heritage district
Heroes and notable figures	Manuel Roxas; Jovita Fuentes; Panay Bukidnon epic chanters
History snapshot	Capiz was a major province of Panay before Aklan separated in 1956. Its identity combines seafood and river culture, Hiligaynon and Capiznon speech, church heritage, and the birthplace of President Manuel Roxas.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; kadang-kadang; boat races; palo-sebo; harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla and guitar, drums, bamboo instruments, and Panay Bukidnon gongs and percussion
Music and oral traditions	composo/komposo narrative songs, Panay Bukidnon sugidanon epics, Hiligaynon balitaw, devotional music, and festival drum ensembles
Languages and speech varieties	Capiznon; Hiligaynon; Aklanon in border areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	binanog; Sinadya festival dances; Hiligaynon folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Capiz; Region VI (Western Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Iloilo

Record ID: PH-0603000000 | PSGC: 0603000000 | Region: Region VI (Western Visayas) | 2024 population: 2,082,616

Iloilo reflects the traditions of Hiligaynon, Kinaray-a, Ati and Panay Bukidnon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Hiligaynon, Kinaray-a, Ati and Panay Bukidnon communities
Festivals and festivities	Dinagyang Festival; Paraw Regatta; Kasadyahan Festival
Food and culinary culture	La Paz batchoy; pancit molo; biscocho; barquillos; KBL
Historical and cultural places	Miagao Church; Molo Church; Jaro Cathedral; Calle Real; Casa Real de Iloilo
Heroes and notable figures	Graciano López Jaena; Teresa Magbanua; Martin Delgado; Magdalena Jalandoni
History snapshot	Iloilo was a major nineteenth-century port and a center of the Revolution in the Visayas. Its heritage includes UNESCO-listed Miagao Church, Hiligaynon literature, Panay Bukidnon epics, and a strong tradition of civic and religious festivals.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; kadang-kadang; boat races; palo-sebo; harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla and guitar, drums, bamboo instruments, and Panay Bukidnon gongs and percussion; rondalla; drums; bamboo and gong instruments
Music and oral traditions	komposo/komposo narrative songs, Panay Bukidnon sugidanon epics, Hiligaynon balitaw, devotional music, and festival drum ensembles; komposo; balitaw; sugidanon epics; devotional music
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon; Kinaray-a; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Dinagyang and Kasadyahan dances; binanog; Hiligaynon folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Iloilo; Region VI (Western Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Guimaras

Record ID: PH-0607900000 | PSGC: 0607900000 | Region: Region VI (Western Visayas) | 2024 population: 192,874

Guimaras reflects the traditions of Hiligaynon and Kinaray-a island communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Hiligaynon and Kinaray-a island communities
Festivals and festivities	Manggahan Festival; Pagtaltal sa Balaan Bukid; Ang Pagtaltal
Food and culinary culture	mangoes; mango pizza; mango tarts; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Guisi Lighthouse; Navalas Church; Balaan Bukid; old Buenavista settlements
Heroes and notable figures	Guimaras community leaders, mango farmers, boat builders and Pagtaltal tradition bearers
History snapshot	Guimaras was a subprovince of Iloilo before becoming a full province in 1992. Its island culture centers on mango farming, fishing, boat travel, and Holy Week traditions.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; kadang-kadang; boat races; palo-sebo; harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	rondalla and guitar, drums, bamboo instruments, and Panay Bukidnon gongs and percussion
Music and oral traditions	composo/komposo narrative songs, Panay Bukidnon sugidanon epics, Hiligaynon balitaw, devotional music, and festival drum ensembles
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon; Kinaray-a; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Manggahan festival dances; Hiligaynon social dances; Pagtaltal dramatic performance
Retrieval aliases	Guimaras; Region VI (Western Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Negros Island Region (NIR)

PSGC region code: 1800000000 | 2024 population: 4,904,944 | Provinces: 3

A region of Hiligaynon- and Cebuano-speaking communities with sugar hacienda history, coastal fishing, mountain Indigenous traditions, strong theater and music cultures, and distinct healing traditions in Siquijor.

Cultural communities	Hiligaynon, Cebuano, Ati, Bukidnon/Magahat, and Siquijodnon communities
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon, Cebuano, Siquijodnon varieties, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; hacienda field games; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and balitaw accompaniment
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, composito, hacienda and sakada songs, Visayan folk songs, and festival music
Folk and ritual dances	balitaw dance forms, sakada-themed dances, MassKara and Buglasan festival dances, and Siquijor Solili/healing-related performances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Negros Occidental

Record ID: PH-1804500000 | PSGC: 1804500000 | Region: Negros Island Region (NIR) | 2024 population: 2,680,477

Negros Occidental reflects the traditions of Hiligaynon communities with Bukidnon/Magahat and migrant groups. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Hiligaynon communities with Bukidnon/Magahat and migrant groups
Festivals and festivities	MassKara Festival; Panaad sa Negros; Cinco de Noviembre
Food and culinary culture	chicken inasal; piaya; napoleones; kansi
Historical and cultural places	The Ruins; Silay heritage houses; Balay Negrense; San Sebastian Cathedral
Heroes and notable figures	Papa Isio; Aniceto Lacson; Juan Araneta; Leandro Locsin
History snapshot	Sugar estates transformed western Negros in the nineteenth century. The 1898 uprising led to the short-lived Republic of Negros, while later labor, peasant, and cultural movements shaped the province's modern identity.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; hacienda field games; coastal boat races; sungka; palo-sebo; farm contests; boat races
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and balitaw accompaniment; rondalla; guitar; drums; brass bands
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, composo, hacienda and sakada songs, Visayan folk songs, and festival music; balitaw; composo; sakada and hacienda songs
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon; Cebuano in some eastern and southern communities; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	MassKara dance; sakada-themed dances; Hiligaynon social dances
Retrieval aliases	Negros Occidental; Negros Island Region (NIR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Negros Oriental

Record ID: PH-1804600000 | PSGC: 1804600000 | Region: Negros Island Region (NIR) | 2024 population: 1,492,038

Negros Oriental reflects the traditions of Cebuano communities with Hiligaynon and Indigenous highland groups. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cebuano communities with Hiligaynon and Indigenous highland groups
Festivals and festivities	Buglasan Festival; Sandurot Festival; Hudyaka sa Bais
Food and culinary culture	budbud kabog; silvanas; sans rival; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Silliman Hall and museum; Dumaguete Belfry; Rizal Boulevard; Cata-al War Memorabilia
Heroes and notable figures	Pantaleon Villegas (Leon Kilat); Eddie Romero; cultural writers associated with Silliman University
History snapshot	Eastern Negros became a separate province in 1890. Dumaguete developed as an educational and literary center, while Leon Kilat linked the province to the Cebu revolutionary movement.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; hacienda field games; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and balitaw accompaniment
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, composo, hacienda and sakada songs, Visayan folk songs, and festival music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Hiligaynon in some areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	balitaw dance forms; Buglasan festival dances; Cebuano folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Negros Oriental; Negros Island Region (NIR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Siquijor

Record ID: PH-1806100000 | PSGC: 1806100000 | Region: Negros Island Region (NIR) | 2024 population: 107,642

Siquijor reflects the traditions of Siquijodnon/Cebuano island communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Siquijodnon/Cebuano island communities
Festivals and festivities	Solili Festival; Healing Festival; Dilaab Festival
Food and culinary culture	torta; pan bisaya; seafood; peanut and coconut products
Historical and cultural places	Lazi Church and Convent; St. Francis de Assisi Church; old balete tree and healing sites
Heroes and notable figures	Traditional mananambal/healers, herbalists, and oral-tradition bearers
History snapshot	Siquijor was once a subprovince of Negros Oriental and became a province in 1971. Its reputation for herbal healing and ritual specialists is part of a broader living tradition that includes Catholic devotion and island folklore.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; palo-sebo; hacienda field games; coastal boat races
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and balitaw accompaniment; guitar; drums; bamboo percussion; ritual sound objects
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, composo, hacienda and sakada songs, Visayan folk songs, and festival music; healing chants, folk prayers, and Visayan songs
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano/Siquijodnon varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Solili; healing ritual performances; Cebuano social dances
Retrieval aliases	Siquijor; Negros Island Region (NIR); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region VII (Central Visayas)

PSGC region code: 0700000000 | 2024 population: 6,640,875 | Provinces: 2

A Cebuano/Boholano region with major precolonial trade centers, early Spanish colonial sites, sea-oriented livelihoods, Catholic devotional traditions, guitar making, balitaw music, and well-known dance festivals.

Cultural communities	Cebuano, Boholano, Bantayanon, Porohanon, Eskaya, and island communities
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano and Boholano varieties, Bantayanon, Porohanon, Eskayan cultural language, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; tubigan and chasing games; boat races; coconut games
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria and rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and church music instruments
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, daygon, Cebuano and Boholano folk songs, devotional songs, and festival drum music
Folk and ritual dances	Sinulog, kuradang, balitaw dance forms, Bolibongkingking, and local fiesta dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Bohol

Record ID: PH-0701200000 | PSGC: 0701200000 | Region: Region VII (Central Visayas) | 2024 population: 1,412,726

Bohol reflects the traditions of Boholano/Cebuano and Eskaya communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Boholano/Cebuano and Eskaya communities
Festivals and festivities	Sandugo Festival; Saulog Festival; Ubi Festival
Food and culinary culture	peanut kisses; calamay; broas; asin tibuok; ubi products
Historical and cultural places	Baclayon Church; Blood Compact Shrine; Dagohoy sites; Loboc Church and heritage district
Heroes and notable figures	Francisco Dagohoy; Tamblot; Carlos P. Garcia; Eskaya cultural teachers
History snapshot	Bohol is associated with the 1565 blood compact tradition and with two major anti-colonial revolts: Tamblot's uprising and the long Dagohoy Rebellion. Church architecture, salt making, music, and island agriculture remain major cultural features.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; tubigan and chasing games; boat races; coconut games
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria and rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and church music instruments; guitar; rondalla; drums; bamboo instruments
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, daygon, Cebuano and Boholano folk songs, devotional songs, and festival drum music; balitaw; daygon; Boholano folk songs
Languages and speech varieties	Boholano/Cebuano varieties; Eskayan cultural language; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kuradang; Bolibongkingking; Sandugo festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Bohol; Region VII (Central Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Cebu

Record ID: PH-0702200000 | PSGC: 0702200000 | Region: Region VII (Central Visayas) | 2024 population: 3,400,522

Cebu reflects the traditions of Cebuano, Bantayanon, Porohanon and island communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cebuano, Bantayanon, Porohanon and island communities
Festivals and festivities	Sinulog Festival; Kadaugan sa Mactan; Pasigarbo sa Sugbo
Food and culinary culture	lechon; danggit; otap; dried mangoes; puso
Historical and cultural places	Magellan’s Cross; Mactan Shrine; Fort San Pedro; Basilica Minore del Santo Niño; Yap-Sandiego House
Heroes and notable figures	Lapu-Lapu; Leon Kilat; Sergio Osmeña; Vicente Sotto
History snapshot	Cebu was a major precolonial trading polity and the site of the Battle of Mactan in 1521. The first permanent Spanish settlement was established in 1565, making Cebu central to early colonial, Christian, and urban history.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; tubigan and chasing games; boat races; coconut games; sungka; sipa; boat races; coconut games
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria and rondalla, drums, brass bands, bamboo instruments, and church music instruments; guitar; bandurria; drums; brass bands
Music and oral traditions	balitaw, daygon, Cebuano and Boholano folk songs, devotional songs, and festival drum music; balitaw; daygon; Cebuano folk songs and guitar music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Bantayanon; Porohanon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Sinulog; balitaw dance forms; Cebuano social dances
Retrieval aliases	Cebu; Region VII (Central Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region VIII (Eastern Visayas)

PSGC region code: 0800000000 | 2024 population: 4,625,929 | Provinces: 6

A Waray- and Cebuano-speaking region with fishing, farming, mat weaving, shipbuilding, epic local histories, strong resistance narratives, and music and dance centered on the kuratsa and community fiestas.

Cultural communities	Waray, Cebuano, Baybayanon, Abuyog and other Eastern Visayan communities
Languages and speech varieties	Waray, Cebuano, Baybayanon and local speech varieties, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands
Folk and ritual dances	tinikling, kuratsa, Sinulog-influenced dances, and local festival dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Eastern Samar

Record ID: PH-0802600000 | PSGC: 0802600000 | Region: Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 2024 population: 472,683

Eastern Samar reflects the traditions of Waray communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Waray communities
Festivals and festivities	Padul-ong Festival; Balangiga Encounter commemorations; Karayapan
Food and culinary culture	moron; salukara; seafood; binagol
Historical and cultural places	Balangiga Church and bells; Homonhon Island; Guiuan Church; historic coastal towns
Heroes and notable figures	Eugenio Daza; Valeriano Abanador; Balangiga townspeople and resistance fighters
History snapshot	Homonhon was the first island reached by Magellan’s expedition in the Philippines in 1521. Balangiga became internationally known for the 1901 conflict and the long campaign for the return of its church bells.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion; rondalla; guitar; drums; brass bands
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands; Waray siday and folk songs; kuratsa music
Languages and speech varieties	Waray; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kuratsa; tinikling; Padul-ong festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Eastern Samar; Region VIII (Eastern Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Leyte

Record ID: PH-0803700000 | PSGC: 0803700000 | Region: Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 2024 population: 1,823,458

Leyte reflects the traditions of Waray and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Waray and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Pintados-Kasadyaan Festival; Sangyaw Festival; Buyogan Festival
Food and culinary culture	binagol; moron; chocolate moron; suman
Historical and cultural places	MacArthur Landing Memorial; Palo Cathedral; Santo Niño Shrine; Hill 522 and wartime sites
Heroes and notable figures	Bankaw; Norberto Romualdez; Leyteño guerrillas and World War II veterans
History snapshot	Leyte is linked to the Bankaw Revolt of 1622 and the Allied return in October 1944. The province is also widely associated with the origin and development of the tinikling dance.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands
Languages and speech varieties	Waray; Cebuano; Baybayanon and local varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	tinikling; kuratsa; Pintados-Kasadyaan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Leyte; Region VIII (Eastern Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Northern Samar

Record ID: PH-0804800000 | PSGC: 0804800000 | Region: Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 2024 population: 645,789

Northern Samar reflects the traditions of Waray communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Waray communities
Festivals and festivities	Ibabao Festival; Sumuroy Festival; Catubig festivals
Food and culinary culture	binagol; tuba; seafood; root-crop dishes
Historical and cultural places	Palapag Church ruins and Sumuroy markers; Capul Church/Fortress; Biri rock cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Juan Ponce Sumuroy; Palapag resistance leaders
History snapshot	Northern Samar includes Palapag, center of the 1649 Sumuroy Revolt against forced labor. The province was created in 1965 when the old province of Samar was divided.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands
Languages and speech varieties	Waray; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kuratsa; tinikling; Ibabao festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Northern Samar; Region VIII (Eastern Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Samar

Record ID: PH-0806000000 | PSGC: 0806000000 | Region: Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 2024 population: 806,179

Samar reflects the traditions of Waray communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Waray communities
Festivals and festivities	Manaragat Festival; Samar Day; Banigan Festival
Food and culinary culture	tamalos; kinilaw; seafood; taro and coconut dishes
Historical and cultural places	Basey Church; Sohoton caves and natural bridge; Basey banig-weaving communities; Catbalogan heritage sites
Heroes and notable figures	Vicente Lukban as an associated revolutionary commander; Samar guerrillas and cultural bearers
History snapshot	The island was known in early records as Ibabao and Samar. The province experienced intense resistance during the Philippine-American War and was divided into three provinces in 1965.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion; guitar; rondalla; drums; weaving-rhythm performances
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands; Waray siday; sea songs; kuratsa music
Languages and speech varieties	Waray; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	tinikling; kuratsa; banig and fishing festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Samar; Region VIII (Eastern Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Southern Leyte

Record ID: PH-0806400000 | PSGC: 0806400000 | Region: Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 2024 population: 434,372

Southern Leyte reflects the traditions of Cebuano and Waray communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cebuano and Waray communities
Festivals and festivities	Sinugdan Festival; Sinulog sa Malitbog; Limasawa commemorations
Food and culinary culture	suman; seaweed dishes; seafood; torta
Historical and cultural places	Limasawa First Mass Shrine; Maasin Cathedral; old coastal churches; wartime sites
Heroes and notable figures	Rajah Kolambu as a historical figure; local guerrillas and seafarers
History snapshot	Southern Leyte was separated from Leyte in 1959. Limasawa is associated with the 1521 Easter Sunday Mass tradition and with early encounters between island leaders and the Magellan expedition.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Waray; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kuratsa; Sinulog sa Malitbog; Limasawa commemorative dances
Retrieval aliases	Southern Leyte; Region VIII (Eastern Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Biliran

Record ID: PH-0807800000 | PSGC: 0807800000 | Region: Region VIII (Eastern Visayas) | 2024 population: 184,095

Biliran reflects the traditions of Waray and Cebuano island communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Waray and Cebuano island communities
Festivals and festivities	Bagasumbol Festival; Biliran Day; Hudyaka
Food and culinary culture	suman; moron; seafood; root-crop dishes
Historical and cultural places	Naval Cathedral; Biliran church and wartime markers; Sambawan cultural seascape; old island settlements
Heroes and notable figures	Biliranon resistance fighters, seafarers, educators, and community leaders
History snapshot	Biliran was historically part of Leyte and became an independent province in 1992. Its culture reflects both Waray and Cebuano influences, volcanic landscapes, fishing, and island mobility.
Games and recreation	sungka; sipa; boat races; luksong lubid; coconut games; sepak takraw
Instruments and material culture	guitar, bandurria, rondalla, drums, brass bands, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Waray siday poetry, kuratsa music, daygon and devotional songs, sea songs, and fiesta bands
Languages and speech varieties	Waray; Cebuano; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kuratsa; tinikling; Bagasumbol festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Biliran; Region VIII (Eastern Visayas); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula)

PSGC region code: 0900000000 | 2024 population: 5,089,934 | Provinces: 4

A culturally diverse peninsula and island region where Subanen, Cebuano, Chavacano, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, and other communities meet. Its heritage includes sultanate history, Spanish-era settlements, Islamic arts, Subanen ritual systems, and maritime trade.

Cultural communities	Subanen/Subanon, Cebuano, Chavacano, Tausug, Sama, Yakan, and coastal communities
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano, Subanen languages, Chavacano, Tausug, Sama varieties, Yakan in some communities, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; boat races; silat and martial games; coconut and harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, gabbang, biyula, suling, bamboo instruments, guitar, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Subanen buklog chants, Tausug parang sabil and lugu/kalangan traditions, Chavacano songs, kulintang repertoire, and Visayan folk music
Folk and ritual dances	pangalay, burung-talo, Subanen buklog dances, Chavacano festival dances, and regional street dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Sulu

Record ID: PH-0906600000 | PSGC: 0906600000 | Region: Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 2024 population: 1,146,097

Sulu reflects the traditions of Tausug, Sama and Bajau communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tausug, Sama and Bajau communities
Festivals and festivities	Manggis Festival; Sulu Arts and Culture Festival; Maulid and community celebrations
Food and culinary culture	tiyula itum; piyassak; daral; bangbang sug; latal
Historical and cultural places	Jolo Walled City; Tulay Mosque; Bud Dajo; Sultanate and royal cemetery sites
Heroes and notable figures	Panglima Hassan; Hadji Butu; Sultan Jamalul Kiram II; Tausug cultural bearers
History snapshot	Sulu was the center of a powerful maritime sultanate that maintained regional trade and diplomatic relations for centuries. It was excluded from BARMM by a Supreme Court ruling and officially transferred to Region IX in 2025, while retaining deep Bangsamoro cultural ties.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; boat races; silat and martial games; coconut and harvest contests; sipa/sepak takraw; silat; boat races; sungka
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, gabbang, biyula, suling, bamboo instruments, guitar, and drums; kulintang; gabbang; agung; biyula; suling
Music and oral traditions	Subanen buklog chants, Tausug parang sabil and lugu/kalangan traditions, Chavacano songs, kulintang repertoire, and Visayan folk music; parang sabil; lugu and kalangan; Tausug epic and lyric traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Tausug; Sama languages; Sinama/Bajau varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pangalay; burung-talo; igal; Tausug martial dances
Retrieval aliases	Sulu; Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Zamboanga del Norte

Record ID: PH-0907200000 | PSGC: 0907200000 | Region: Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 2024 population: 1,067,067

Zamboanga del Norte reflects the traditions of Cebuano, Subanen and Chavacano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cebuano, Subanen and Chavacano communities
Festivals and festivities	Kinabayo Festival; Hudyaka Zanorte; Sinulog sa Dipolog
Food and culinary culture	bottled sardines; suman; seafood; cassava cakes
Historical and cultural places	Rizal Shrine in Dapitan; Punto del Desembarco; St. James Church; old Dapitan plaza
Heroes and notable figures	José Rizal as an associated national figure; Subanen cultural bearers
History snapshot	The province was created in 1952 when the old Zamboanga Province was divided. Dapitan is nationally significant as José Rizal's place of exile from 1892 to 1896.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; boat races; silat and martial games; coconut and harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, gabbang, biyula, suling, bamboo instruments, guitar, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Subanen buklog chants, Tausug parang sabil and lugu/kalangan traditions, Chavacano songs, kulintang repertoire, and Visayan folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Subanen languages; Chavacano in some communities; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Kinabayo; Subanen ritual dances; Cebuano festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Zamboanga del Norte; Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Zamboanga del Sur

Record ID: PH-0907300000 | PSGC: 0907300000 | Region: Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 2024 population: 1,045,126

Zamboanga del Sur reflects the traditions of Subanen, Cebuano, Chavacano and Maguindanaon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Subanen, Cebuano, Chavacano and Maguindanaon communities
Festivals and festivities	Megayon Festival; Pasalamat Festival; Pagadian City festivals
Food and culinary culture	curacha; satti; seafood; lokot-lokot
Historical and cultural places	Pagadian Rotonda; Subanen cultural villages; old Spanish and wartime sites; Dao-Dao coastal landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Vicente Álvarez and Roseller T. Lim as regional historical figures; Subanen timuay
History snapshot	Created in 1952 from the old Zamboanga Province, Zamboanga del Sur combines Subanen ancestral culture with Cebuano, Chavacano, and Muslim communities. Pagadian developed as its administrative and commercial center.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; boat races; silat and martial games; coconut and harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, gabbang, biyula, suling, bamboo instruments, guitar, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Subanen buklog chants, Tausug parang sabil and lugu/kalangan traditions, Chavacano songs, kulintang repertoire, and Visayan folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Subanen languages; Chavacano; Maguindanaon in some areas; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Megayon dances; Subanen buklog dances; Chavacano and Cebuano festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Zamboanga del Sur; Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Zamboanga Sibugay

Record ID: PH-0908300000 | PSGC: 0908300000 | Region: Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula) | 2024 population: 661,498

Zamboanga Sibugay reflects the traditions of Subanen, Cebuano, Chavacano, Tausug and Yakan communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Subanen, Cebuano, Chavacano, Tausug and Yakan communities
Festivals and festivities	Sibug-Sibug Festival; Buklog-related community celebrations; municipal fiestas
Food and culinary culture	oysters; seafood; cassava cakes; native rice cakes
Historical and cultural places	Subanen cultural sites; old Sibuguey settlements; Kabug Mangrove Park; Buluan Island
Heroes and notable figures	Subanen timuay, ritual specialists and community defenders
History snapshot	Zamboanga Sibugay was created in 2001 from Zamboanga del Sur. Its identity is rooted in the Sibuguey Bay, Subanen communities, coastal trade, fishing, and settler migration.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; boat races; silat and martial games; coconut and harvest contests
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, gabbang, biyula, suling, bamboo instruments, guitar, and drums
Music and oral traditions	Subanen buklog chants, Tausug parang sabil and lugu/kalangan traditions, Chavacano songs, kulintang repertoire, and Visayan folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Subanen languages; Chavacano; Tausug and Yakan in some communities; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Subanen buklog dances; Sibug-Sibug festival dances; coastal folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Zamboanga Sibugay; Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region X (Northern Mindanao)

PSGC region code: 1000000000 | 2024 population: 5,178,326 | Provinces: 5

A region where Higaonon, Talaandig, Bukidnon, Manobo, Maranao, Subanen, Cebuano, and island communities maintain epic, ritual, agricultural, and maritime traditions.

Cultural communities	Higaonon, Talaandig, Bukidnon, Manobo, Maranao, Subanen/Kolibugan, Cebuano, and Camiguinon communities
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano, Binukid, Higaonon, Talaandig and Manobo languages, Maranao, Subanen varieties, Kinamigin/Camiguinon, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; tug-of-war; archery and spear throwing; horse and harvest games; boat races
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, kubing, kudyapi, bamboo flutes, drums, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	ulaging and other highland epics, limbay and ritual chants, Maranao song traditions, Subanen chants, and Cebuano folk music
Folk and ritual dances	dugso, binanog, Kaamulan tribal dances, singkil and sagayan in Lanao communities, and local festival dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Bukidnon

Record ID: PH-1001300000 | PSGC: 1001300000 | Region: Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 2024 population: 1,601,902

Bukidnon reflects the traditions of Bukidnon, Higaonon, Talaandig, Manobo and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Bukidnon, Higaonon, Talaandig, Manobo and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Kaamulan Festival; Pineapple Festival; Malaybalay Charter Day
Food and culinary culture	binaki; pineapple products; coffee; sinuglaw; native rice
Historical and cultural places	Kaamulan grounds; Talaandig School of Living Traditions; Monastery of Transfiguration; Mt. Kitanglad ancestral landscapes
Heroes and notable figures	Datu Mampaalong; Talaandig and Higaonon cultural masters; Indigenous rights leaders
History snapshot	Bukidnon is a highland homeland of several Indigenous peoples and became a regular province in 1917. Kaamulan is designed as a gathering of the province's recognized Indigenous communities and their living traditions.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; tug-of-war; archery and spear throwing; horse and harvest games; boat races; archery; spear throwing; tug-of-war; horse and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, kubing, kudyapi, bamboo flutes, drums, and indigenous percussion; agung; kulintang; kubing; bamboo flutes and percussion
Music and oral traditions	ulaging and other highland epics, limbay and ritual chants, Maranao song traditions, Subanen chants, and Cebuano folk music; ulaging; limbay; ritual chants and gong music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Binukid; Higaonon; Talaandig and Manobo languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	dugso; binanog; Kaamulan tribal dances
Retrieval aliases	Bukidnon; Region X (Northern Mindanao); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Camiguin

Record ID: PH-1001800000 | PSGC: 1001800000 | Region: Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 2024 population: 94,892

Camiguin reflects the traditions of Camiguinon/Cebuano island communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Camiguinon/Cebuano island communities
Festivals and festivities	Lanzones Festival; Panaad; San Juan Hibok-Hibok Festival
Food and culinary culture	pastel; lanzones; kiping; seafood
Historical and cultural places	Sunken Cemetery; Old Catarman Church Ruins; Spanish watchtower; volcanic heritage sites
Heroes and notable figures	Camiguinon community leaders, seafarers and heritage conservators
History snapshot	Camiguin's culture is inseparable from its volcanoes. The 1871 eruption of Mt. Vulcan destroyed old Catarman, leaving the church ruins and submerged cemetery that now define island memory.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; tug-of-war; archery and spear throwing; horse and harvest games; boat races
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, kubing, kudyapi, bamboo flutes, drums, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	ulaging and other highland epics, limbay and ritual chants, Maranao song traditions, Subanen chants, and Cebuano folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano/Camiguinon; Kinamigin; Boholano varieties; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Lanzones festival dances; Sinulog and island folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Camiguin; Region X (Northern Mindanao); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Lanao del Norte

Record ID: PH-1003500000 | PSGC: 1003500000 | Region: Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 2024 population: 761,725

Lanao del Norte reflects the traditions of Maranao, Higaonon, Kolibugan/Subanen and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Maranao, Higaonon, Kolibugan/Subanen and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Sagingan Festival; Alimango Festival; Sagayan Festival
Food and culinary culture	palapa; dodol; native rice cakes; lechon and seafood
Historical and cultural places	Maranao and Higaonon cultural communities; Kolambugan heritage sites; Kapatagan wartime sites; waterfalls and river landscapes
Heroes and notable figures	Amai Pakpak as a wider Lanao hero; Maranao and Higaonon leaders
History snapshot	Lanao del Norte was created in 1959 when the old Lanao Province was divided. Its culture reflects Maranao, Higaonon, Kolibugan/Subanen, and Cebuano communities and the historical relationship with nearby Iligan.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; tug-of-war; archery and spear throwing; horse and harvest games; boat races
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, kubing, kudyapi, bamboo flutes, drums, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	ulaging and other highland epics, limbay and ritual chants, Maranao song traditions, Subanen chants, and Cebuano folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Maranao; Higaonon; Kolibugan/Subanen; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	singkil; sagayan; kapa malong-malong; Higaonon dances
Retrieval aliases	Lanao del Norte; Region X (Northern Mindanao); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Misamis Occidental

Record ID: PH-1004200000 | PSGC: 1004200000 | Region: Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 2024 population: 621,993

Misamis Occidental reflects the traditions of Cebuano and Subanen communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cebuano and Subanen communities
Festivals and festivities	Perangat/Pas'ungko Festival; Sinulog sa Tangub; Dalit Festival
Food and culinary culture	suman; calamay; seafood; lechon
Historical and cultural places	Ozamiz Cotta Fort; Jimenez heritage church and houses; José Ozámiz memorial sites; Oroquieta old town
Heroes and notable figures	José F. Ozámiz; Subanen cultural leaders and World War II resistance figures
History snapshot	Misamis Occidental was created in 1929 when Misamis was divided. The province's name and the city of Ozamiz honor José Ozámiz, a senator and wartime martyr executed during the Japanese occupation.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; tug-of-war; archery and spear throwing; horse and harvest games; boat races
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, kubing, kudyapi, bamboo flutes, drums, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	ulaging and other highland epics, limbay and ritual chants, Maranao song traditions, Subanen chants, and Cebuano folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Subanen languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Subanen buklog dances; Sinulog sa Tangub; Perangat festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Misamis Occidental; Region X (Northern Mindanao); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Misamis Oriental

Record ID: PH-1004300000 | PSGC: 1004300000 | Region: Region X (Northern Mindanao) | 2024 population: 988,065

Misamis Oriental reflects the traditions of Cebuano and Higaonon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Cebuano and Higaonon communities
Festivals and festivities	Higalaay Festival; Kuyamis Festival; Kagay-an Festival
Food and culinary culture	pastel; hamon de Cagayan; binaki; sinuglaw
Historical and cultural places	Macahambus Cave and battle site; Huluga archaeological site; old Cagayan de Oro heritage sites; Higaonon ancestral areas
Heroes and notable figures	Nicolas Capistrano; Apolinar Vélez; Higaonon cultural leaders
History snapshot	Misamis Oriental was formed in 1929. Cagayan de Oro and Macahambus are linked to revolutionary and Philippine-American War events, while Higaonon communities maintain strong upland traditions.
Games and recreation	sipa; sungka; tug-of-war; archery and spear throwing; horse and harvest games; boat races
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, kubing, kudyapi, bamboo flutes, drums, and indigenous percussion
Music and oral traditions	ulaging and other highland epics, limbay and ritual chants, Maranao song traditions, Subanen chants, and Cebuano folk music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Higaonon; Binukid in uplands; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Higaonon ritual dances; Higalaay and Kuyamis festival dances; binanog
Retrieval aliases	Misamis Oriental; Region X (Northern Mindanao); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region XI (Davao Region)

PSGC region code: 1100000000 | 2024 population: 5,389,422 | Provinces: 5

A multicultural region where Bagobo, Mandaya, Mansaka, Ata, Obu Manuvu, Blaan, Kalagan, Tagakaulo, Cebuano, and migrant communities meet. Weaving, beadwork, brass casting, agriculture, and ritual performance are central cultural features.

Cultural communities	Bagobo, Mandaya, Mansaka, Ata Manobo, Obu Manuvu, Blaan, Kalagan, Tagakaulo, Cebuano, and migrant communities
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano, Mandaya, Mansaka, Dibabawon, Ata Manobo, Obu Manuvu, Bagobo-Klata/Giangan, Blaan, Kalagan, Tagakaulo, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	archery; spear throwing; sipa; tug-of-war; tribal races; coconut and farm games
Instruments and material culture	agung, kulintang, kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, bamboo zithers, drums, and brass percussion
Music and oral traditions	Mandaya and Mansaka chants, Bagobo and Manobo oral traditions, gong music, ritual songs, and migrant Cebuano music
Folk and ritual dances	Mandaya, Mansaka, Bagobo, Blaan and Manobo ritual dances, binanog, dugso, and festival street dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Davao del Norte

Record ID: PH-1102300000 | PSGC: 1102300000 | Region: Region XI (Davao Region) | 2024 population: 1,143,931

Davao del Norte reflects the traditions of Ata Manobo, Mandaya, Sama and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Ata Manobo, Mandaya, Sama and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Kadagayaan Festival; Musikahan sa Tagum; Hugyaw sa Kadagayaan
Food and culinary culture	banana chips; durian products; kinilaw; cacao products
Historical and cultural places	Tagum cultural center; Samal island caves and settlements; banana plantation heritage; Indigenous communities
Heroes and notable figures	Datu Bago as a regional resistance figure; Ata Manobo and Mandaya leaders
History snapshot	Davao del Norte was created in 1967 from the old Davao Province. Its modern culture reflects Indigenous communities, settler migration, plantation agriculture, music festivals, and island traditions in Samal.
Games and recreation	archery; spear throwing; sipa; tug-of-war; tribal races; coconut and farm games
Instruments and material culture	agung, kulintang, kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, bamboo zithers, drums, and brass percussion
Music and oral traditions	Mandaya and Mansaka chants, Bagobo and Manobo oral traditions, gong music, ritual songs, and migrant Cebuano music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Ata Manobo; Mandaya; Sama varieties in island communities; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Ata Manobo and Mandaya dances; Musikahan festival dances; binanog
Retrieval aliases	Davao del Norte; Region XI (Davao Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Davao del Sur

Record ID: PH-1102400000 | PSGC: 1102400000 | Region: Region XI (Davao Region) | 2024 population: 705,129

Davao del Sur reflects the traditions of Blaan, Bagobo-Klata/Giangan, Obu Manuvu and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Blaan, Bagobo-Klata/Giangan, Obu Manuvu and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Araw ng Digos; Kapatagan Festival; Padigosan Festival
Food and culinary culture	durian; marang; grilled tuna dishes; cacao
Historical and cultural places	Mt. Apo ancestral landscapes; Kapatagan heritage and wartime sites; Blaan and Bagobo communities; Tudaya Falls
Heroes and notable figures	Datu Bago as a regional figure; Blaan, Bagobo and Obu Manuvu cultural leaders
History snapshot	Created in 1967 from the old Davao Province, Davao del Sur includes the southern approaches to Mt. Apo and culturally important Blaan, Bagobo, and Obu Manuvu ancestral domains.
Games and recreation	archery; spear throwing; sipa; tug-of-war; tribal races; coconut and farm games
Instruments and material culture	agung, kulintang, kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, bamboo zithers, drums, and brass percussion
Music and oral traditions	Mandaya and Mansaka chants, Bagobo and Manobo oral traditions, gong music, ritual songs, and migrant Cebuano music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Blaan; Bagobo-Klata/Giangan; Obu Manuvu; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Blaan and Bagobo dances; dugso; Kapatagan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Davao del Sur; Region XI (Davao Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Davao Oriental

Record ID: PH-1102500000 | PSGC: 1102500000 | Region: Region XI (Davao Region) | 2024 population: 590,042

Davao Oriental reflects the traditions of Mandaya, Kalagan, Manobo and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Mandaya, Kalagan, Manobo and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Sambuokan Festival; Pujada Bay Festival; Kalindugan Festival
Food and culinary culture	pomelo; kinilaw; coconut products; cacao
Historical and cultural places	San Salvador del Mundo Church in Caraga; Cape San Agustin lighthouse; Subangan Museum; Mt. Hamiguitan
Heroes and notable figures	Mandaya and Kalagan leaders and cultural bearers; local wartime resistance figures
History snapshot	Davao Oriental was created in 1967. The province is a major Mandaya homeland and includes old Caraga, one of Mindanao's earliest Spanish mission settlements, as well as important coastal and mountain cultural landscapes.
Games and recreation	archery; spear throwing; sipa; tug-of-war; tribal races; coconut and farm games
Instruments and material culture	agung, kulintang, kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, bamboo zithers, drums, and brass percussion
Music and oral traditions	Mandaya and Mansaka chants, Bagobo and Manobo oral traditions, gong music, ritual songs, and migrant Cebuano music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Mandaya; Kalagan; Manobo languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Mandaya dances; Kalagan dances; Sambuokan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Davao Oriental; Region XI (Davao Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Davao de Oro

Record ID: PH-1108200000 | PSGC: 1108200000 | Region: Region XI (Davao Region) | 2024 population: 783,775

Davao de Oro reflects the traditions of Mansaka, Mandaya, Dibabawon, Manobo and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Mansaka, Mandaya, Dibabawon, Manobo and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Bulawan Festival; Kariyawan Festival; Simballay Festival
Food and culinary culture	durian products; cacao/chocolate; banana chips; native rice
Historical and cultural places	Mansaka cultural villages; Mt. Diwalwal mining history; Mainit hot spring; Lake Leonard cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Mansaka and Mandaya elders, weavers, musicians and ancestral-domain leaders
History snapshot	Created in 1998 as Compostela Valley and renamed Davao de Oro in 2019, the province combines mining history, plantation agriculture, and the living traditions of Mansaka, Mandaya, Dibabawon and Manobo communities.
Games and recreation	archery; spear throwing; sipa; tug-of-war; tribal races; coconut and farm games
Instruments and material culture	agung, kulintang, kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, bamboo zithers, drums, and brass percussion
Music and oral traditions	Mandaya and Mansaka chants, Bagobo and Manobo oral traditions, gong music, ritual songs, and migrant Cebuano music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Mansaka; Mandaya; Dibabawon; Manobo languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Mansaka and Mandaya dances; binanog; Bulawan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Davao de Oro; Region XI (Davao Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Davao Occidental

Record ID: PH-1108600000 | PSGC: 1108600000 | Region: Region XI (Davao Region) | 2024 population: 317,598

Davao Occidental reflects the traditions of Blaan, Tagakaulo, Sangir and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Blaan, Tagakaulo, Sangir and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Gaginaway Festival; Araw ng Davao Occidental; Malita festivals
Food and culinary culture	seafood; coconut products; kinilaw; root-crop dishes
Historical and cultural places	Balut Island; Blaan and Sangir cultural communities; Malita heritage sites; coastal settlements
Heroes and notable figures	Blaan, Tagakaulo and Sangir elders, seafarers and community leaders
History snapshot	Davao Occidental was created in 2013 from Davao del Sur. Its culture is strongly coastal and Indigenous, with Blaan, Tagakaulo, Sangir, and Cebuano communities connected to the Celebes Sea.
Games and recreation	archery; spear throwing; sipa; tug-of-war; tribal races; coconut and farm games
Instruments and material culture	agung, kulintang, kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, bamboo zithers, drums, and brass percussion
Music and oral traditions	Mandaya and Mansaka chants, Bagobo and Manobo oral traditions, gong music, ritual songs, and migrant Cebuano music
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Blaan; Tagakaulo; Sangir; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Blaan and Tagakaulo dances; Gaginaway festival dances; coastal folk dances
Retrieval aliases	Davao Occidental; Region XI (Davao Region); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN)

PSGC region code: 1200000000 | 2024 population: 4,462,776 | Provinces: 4

A region of Maguindanaon, Tboli, Blaan, Manobo, Teduray, Hiligaynon, Cebuano, Sangir, and migrant communities. It is known for tnalak weaving, kulintang music, highland epics, tuna and agricultural industries, and lake and mountain cultural landscapes.

Cultural communities	Maguindanaon, Tboli, Blaan, Manobo, Teduray, Hiligaynon, Cebuano, Sangir, and Tagakaulo communities
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon, Cebuano, Maguindanaon, Tboli, Blaan, Manobo languages, Teduray, Sangir, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; archery; horse and farm games; canoe and boat races
Instruments and material culture	hegelung lute, sludoy bamboo zither, kubing, kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Tboli Tudbulul epic, Blaan chants, Maguindanaon kulintang repertoire, bayok, and Hiligaynon/Cebuano migrant songs
Folk and ritual dances	kadal tahaw and other Tboli dances, Blaan dances, sagayan, Manobo ritual dances, and festival street dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Cotabato

Record ID: PH-1204700000 | PSGC: 1204700000 | Region: Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 2024 population: 1,286,142

Cotabato reflects the traditions of Maguindanaon, Manobo, Iranun, Cebuano and Hiligaynon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Maguindanaon, Manobo, Iranun, Cebuano and Hiligaynon communities
Festivals and festivities	Kalivungan Festival; Timpupo Festival; Kidapawan fruit festivals
Food and culinary culture	pastil; durian; tinagtag; native rice and corn dishes
Historical and cultural places	Fort Pikit; Mt. Apo cultural landscapes; Manobo communities; old river and settlement sites
Heroes and notable figures	Datu Uto; Salipada K. Pendatun; Manobo and Maguindanaon leaders
History snapshot	The present Province of Cotabato is a remnant of the much larger historical Cotabato Province. Its culture reflects Maguindanaon and Manobo homelands, settler migration, river trade, and the Mt. Apo frontier.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; archery; horse and farm games; canoe and boat races
Instruments and material culture	hegelung lute, sludoy bamboo zither, kubing, kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Tboli Tudbulul epic, Blaan chants, Maguindanaon kulintang repertoire, bayok, and Hiligaynon/Cebuano migrant songs
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Hiligaynon; Maguindanaon; Iranun; Manobo languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sagayan; Manobo ritual dances; Kalivungan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Cotabato; Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

South Cotabato

Record ID: PH-1206300000 | PSGC: 1206300000 | Region: Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 2024 population: 1,010,009

South Cotabato reflects the traditions of Tboli, Blaan, Hiligaynon, Cebuano and Maguindanaon communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Tboli, Blaan, Hiligaynon, Cebuano and Maguindanaon communities
Festivals and festivities	T'nalak Festival; Lemlunay Festival; Helobung Festival
Food and culinary culture	tilapia dishes; pineapple products; native coffee; lechon
Historical and cultural places	Lake Sebu; Tboli Museum; Lang Dulay weaving center; Seven Falls cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Lang Dulay; Tboli dreamweavers, musicians and epic chanters
History snapshot	Created in 1966, South Cotabato is a major center of Tboli and Blaan heritage alongside Hiligaynon and Cebuano settler communities. Tnalak weaving and Lake Sebu's cultural landscape are internationally recognized symbols of the province.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; archery; horse and farm games; canoe and boat races
Instruments and material culture	hegelung lute, sludoy bamboo zither, kubing, kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, and bamboo percussion; hegelung; sludoy; kubing; agung and kulintang
Music and oral traditions	Tboli Tudbulul epic, Blaan chants, Maguindanaon kulintang repertoire, bayok, and Hiligaynon/Cebuano migrant songs; Tudbulul epic; Tboli songs; gong music
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon; Cebuano; Tboli; Blaan; Maguindanaon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	kadal tahaw and other Tboli dances; Blaan dances; T'nalak festival dances
Retrieval aliases	South Cotabato; Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Sultan Kudarat

Record ID: PH-1206500000 | PSGC: 1206500000 | Region: Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 2024 population: 863,651

Sultan Kudarat reflects the traditions of Maguindanaon, Teduray, Manobo, Hiligaynon and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Maguindanaon, Teduray, Manobo, Hiligaynon and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Kalimudan Festival; Hinugyaw Festival; Tacurong festivals
Food and culinary culture	pastil; tinagtag; native coffee; corn and coconut products
Historical and cultural places	Sultan Kudarat monuments; Teduray cultural villages; Lebak heritage sites; Baras bird sanctuary
Heroes and notable figures	Sultan Muhammad Dipatuan Kudarat; Teduray and Manobo leaders
History snapshot	The province was created in 1973 and named for Sultan Kudarat, the seventeenth-century Maguindanao ruler known for resisting Spanish expansion. It brings together Maguindanaon, Teduray, Manobo, and settler cultures.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; archery; horse and farm games; canoe and boat races
Instruments and material culture	hegelung lute, sludoy bamboo zither, kubing, kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Tboli Tudbulul epic, Blaan chants, Maguindanaon kulintang repertoire, bayok, and Hiligaynon/Cebuano migrant songs
Languages and speech varieties	Hiligaynon; Cebuano; Maguindanaon; Teduray; Manobo languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sagayan; Teduray and Manobo dances; Kalimudan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Sultan Kudarat; Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Sarangani

Record ID: PH-1208000000 | PSGC: 1208000000 | Region: Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN) | 2024 population: 580,915

Sarangani reflects the traditions of Blaan, Tboli, Tagakaulo, Sangir, Maguindanaon and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Blaan, Tboli, Tagakaulo, Sangir, Maguindanaon and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Munato Festival; Sarangani Bay Festival; MunaTo celebrations
Food and culinary culture	tuna; tiyula itum; kinilaw; grilled seafood
Historical and cultural places	Maitum anthropomorphic jars and museum; Blaan cultural villages; Gumasa Beach; Pinol Cave
Heroes and notable figures	Datu Kalun as a Blaan historical figure; Blaan and Tboli cultural masters
History snapshot	Sarangani became a province in 1992 after separation from South Cotabato. The Maitum anthropomorphic jars are among the country’s most important archaeological finds, while Blaan, Tboli, Sangir and coastal cultures remain central.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; archery; horse and farm games; canoe and boat races
Instruments and material culture	hegelung lute, sludoy bamboo zither, kubing, kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, and bamboo percussion
Music and oral traditions	Tboli Tudbulul epic, Blaan chants, Maguindanaon kulintang repertoire, bayok, and Hiligaynon/Cebuano migrant songs
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Blaan; Tboli; Tagakaulo; Sangir; Maguindanaon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Blaan and Tboli dances; kadal tahaw; Munato festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Sarangani; Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Region XIII (Caraga)

PSGC region code: 1600000000 | 2024 population: 2,865,196 | Provinces: 5

A northeastern Mindanao region with Butuanon, Surigaonon, Kamayo, Manobo, Mamanwa, Banwaon, Higaonon, and Cebuano communities. Its history includes the Balangay-era Butuan trading polity, mining, river and sea travel, and strong oral traditions.

Cultural communities	Butuanon, Surigaonon, Kamayo, Agusan Manobo, Mamanwa, Banwaon, Higaonon, and Cebuano communities
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano, Butuanon, Surigaonon, Kamayo, Agusan Manobo, Banwaon, Mamanwa, Higaonon, Filipino, and English
Games and recreation	boat races; sipa; sungka; surfing contests; archery; river and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, agung, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and gong ensembles
Music and oral traditions	Manobo epics and bayok, Mamanwa and Higaonon chants, Surigaonon songs, and river/coastal music traditions
Folk and ritual dances	Manobo and Mamanwa ritual dances, binanog, bonok-bonok, itik-itik, and local festival dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Agusan del Norte

Record ID: PH-1600200000 | PSGC: 1600200000 | Region: Region XIII (Caraga) | 2024 population: 404,100

Agusan del Norte reflects the traditions of Butuanon, Manobo, Higaonon, Mamanwa, Surigaonon and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Butuanon, Manobo, Higaonon, Mamanwa, Surigaonon and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Kahimunan Festival; Lisagan Festival; Dagkot Festival
Food and culinary culture	palagsing; nilambiran; seafood; sago and root-crop dishes
Historical and cultural places	Balangay Shrine Museum; Banza Church ruins; Magellan’s Anchorage; Cabadbaran heritage houses
Heroes and notable figures	Rajah Siagu as a historical Butuan ruler; balangay builders and Manobo/Mamanwa cultural bearers
History snapshot	The province was formed in 1967 when Agusan was divided. Its cultural history is closely linked to the ancient Butuan trading polity and balangay boats, even though Butuan City is now administratively independent.
Games and recreation	boat races; sipa; sungka; surfing contests; archery; river and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, agung, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and gong ensembles
Music and oral traditions	Manobo epics and bayok, Mamanwa and Higaonon chants, Surigaonon songs, and river/coastal music traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Butuanon; Agusan Manobo; Higaonon; Mamanwa; Surigaonon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Kahimunan; Manobo and Mamanwa dances; river and harvest dances
Retrieval aliases	Agusan del Norte; Region XIII (Caraga); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Agusan del Sur

Record ID: PH-1600300000 | PSGC: 1600300000 | Region: Region XIII (Caraga) | 2024 population: 740,531

Agusan del Sur reflects the traditions of Agusan Manobo, Banwaon, Higaonon and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Agusan Manobo, Banwaon, Higaonon and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Naliyagan Festival; Kahimunan celebrations; Araw ng Agusan del Sur
Food and culinary culture	palagsing; native honey; tilapia dishes; sago products
Historical and cultural places	Agusan Marsh; Golden Tara discovery area; Bunawan cultural sites; Manobo ancestral communities
Heroes and notable figures	Agusan Manobo and Banwaon elders, epic chanters and ancestral-domain leaders
History snapshot	Agusan del Sur was created in 1967. The Agusan Marsh and river system shaped Manobo settlements and trade, while the discovery of the Golden Tara linked the area to wider Southeast Asian cultural networks.
Games and recreation	boat races; sipa; sungka; surfing contests; archery; river and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, agung, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and gong ensembles
Music and oral traditions	Manobo epics and bayok, Mamanwa and Higaonon chants, Surigaonon songs, and river/coastal music traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Cebuano; Agusan Manobo; Banwaon; Higaonon; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Manobo ritual and war dances; binanog; Naliyagan festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Agusan del Sur; Region XIII (Caraga); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Surigao del Norte

Record ID: PH-1606700000 | PSGC: 1606700000 | Region: Region XIII (Caraga) | 2024 population: 565,644

Surigao del Norte reflects the traditions of Surigaonon, Mamanwa and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Surigaonon, Mamanwa and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Bonok-Bonok Maradjaw Karadjaw Festival; Siargao festivals; Charter Day
Food and culinary culture	sayongsong; kinilaw; seafood; dried fish
Historical and cultural places	Battle of Surigao Strait Memorial; Surigaonon heritage sites; Siargao cultural landscapes; Sohoton/Bucas Grande
Heroes and notable figures	Surigaonon wartime veterans; Mamanwa cultural bearers; local seafarers
History snapshot	Surigao del Norte was created in 1960 when the old Surigao Province was divided. It is associated with the 1944 Battle of Surigao Strait, mining, fishing, and the modern global surf culture of Siargao.
Games and recreation	boat races; sipa; sungka; surfing contests; archery; river and harvest games; surfing; boat races; sipa; sungka
Instruments and material culture	kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, agung, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and gong ensembles; kudlong; kubing; drums; guitar
Music and oral traditions	Manobo epics and bayok, Mamanwa and Higaonon chants, Surigaonon songs, and river/coastal music traditions; Surigaonon songs; Manobo/Mamanwa chants; festival music
Languages and speech varieties	Surigaonon; Cebuano; Mamanwa; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	bonok-bonok; itik-itik traditions; Mamanwa ritual dances
Retrieval aliases	Surigao del Norte; Region XIII (Caraga); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Surigao del Sur

Record ID: PH-1606800000 | PSGC: 1606800000 | Region: Region XIII (Caraga) | 2024 population: 648,858

Surigao del Sur reflects the traditions of Kamayo, Surigaonon, Manobo and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Kamayo, Surigaonon, Manobo and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Kaliguan Festival; Lanuza Surfing Festival; Sirong Festival
Food and culinary culture	sayongsong; seafood; kinilaw; cassava products
Historical and cultural places	Old Cantilan heritage sites; Kamayo and Manobo communities; Tinuy-an Falls; Enchanted River cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Kamayo and Manobo elders, ritual specialists and cultural workers
History snapshot	Created in 1960, Surigao del Sur is a major home of Kamayo and Manobo communities. Its coast and river systems support fishing, farming, surfing, and ritual traditions.
Games and recreation	boat races; sipa; sungka; surfing contests; archery; river and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, agung, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and gong ensembles
Music and oral traditions	Manobo epics and bayok, Mamanwa and Higaonon chants, Surigaonon songs, and river/coastal music traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Kamayo; Surigaonon; Cebuano; Manobo languages; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	itik-itik; Manobo dances; Kaliguan and Sirong festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Surigao del Sur; Region XIII (Caraga); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Dinagat Islands

Record ID: PH-1608500000 | PSGC: 1608500000 | Region: Region XIII (Caraga) | 2024 population: 120,533

Dinagat Islands reflects the traditions of Surigaonon and Cebuano island communities with Indigenous heritage. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Surigaonon and Cebuano island communities with Indigenous heritage
Festivals and festivities	Sirong-Sirong Festival; Bugkosan Festival; Dinagat Day
Food and culinary culture	seafood; cassava cakes; kinilaw; coconut products
Historical and cultural places	Lake Bababu; old San Jose settlements; wartime sites; island mining and seafaring landscapes
Heroes and notable figures	Dinagat seafarers, community leaders and oral-tradition bearers
History snapshot	Dinagat Islands became a province in 2006; its status was briefly reversed and later restored by the Supreme Court. Island life, fishing, mining, oral tradition, and sea travel shape its culture.
Games and recreation	boat races; sipa; sungka; surfing contests; archery; river and harvest games
Instruments and material culture	kudlong/kudyapi, kubing, agung, bamboo flutes and zithers, drums, and gong ensembles
Music and oral traditions	Manobo epics and bayok, Mamanwa and Higaonon chants, Surigaonon songs, and river/coastal music traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Surigaonon; Cebuano; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	Sirong-Sirong festival dance; Surigaonon island dances
Retrieval aliases	Dinagat Islands; Region XIII (Caraga); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM)

PSGC region code: 1900000000 | 2024 population: 4,545,486 | Provinces: 5

The autonomous region includes major Bangsamoro homelands and Indigenous communities with long sultanate histories, Islamic scholarship, torogan architecture, weaving, metalwork, maritime trade, epic traditions, and highly developed gong music and dance.

Cultural communities	Maranao, Maguindanaon, Iranun, Yakan, Sama, Jama Mapun, Bajau, Tausug-linked communities, Teduray, Lambangian, and other Indigenous groups
Languages and speech varieties	Maranao, Maguindanaon, Iranun, Yakan, Sama languages, Jama Mapun, Sinama/Bajau varieties, Teduray, Filipino, Arabic in religious contexts, and English
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; horse racing and riding games; boat races; silat; archery
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, babandil, kudyapi, kubing, gabbang, biyula, and suling
Music and oral traditions	Darangen epic, bayok and lyrical chants, kulintang repertoire, Islamic devotional recitation, Maranao and Maguindanaon vocal music, and Sama/Yakan traditions
Folk and ritual dances	singkil, sagayan, kapa malong-malong, asik, pangalay/igal, Yakan tumahik, and community ritual dances

Province records follow on the next pages. Shared regional traditions are repeated where useful for retrieval, while province-specific entries identify local communities, events and places.

Basilan

Record ID: PH-1900700000 | PSGC: 1900700000 | Region: Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) | 2024 population: 541,947

Basilan reflects the traditions of Yakan, Tausug, Sama, Chavacano and Cebuano communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Yakan, Tausug, Sama, Chavacano and Cebuano communities
Festivals and festivities	Lami-Lamihan Festival; Yakan Festival; Pakaradjaan celebrations
Food and culinary culture	panyalam; tiyula itum; junay; native cassava and rice cakes
Historical and cultural places	Yakan weaving centers; Lamitan Museum and government center; Bulingan Falls; Malamawi cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Ambalang Ausalin; Uwang Ahadas; Yakan elders and musicians
History snapshot	Basilan became a province in 1973. Its identity is strongly associated with Yakan weaving and music, alongside Tausug, Sama, Chavacano and Cebuano communities; Lamitan is the provincial capital and government center.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; horse racing and riding games; boat races; silat; archery
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, babandil, kudyapi, kubing, gabbang, biyula, and suling; kwintangan/kulintang; agung; gabbang; bamboo instruments
Music and oral traditions	Darangen epic, bayok and lyrical chants, kulintang repertoire, Islamic devotional recitation, Maranao and Maguindanaon vocal music, and Sama/Yakan traditions; Yakan vocal music and gong traditions; Tausug songs
Languages and speech varieties	Yakan; Tausug; Chavacano; Sama languages; Cebuano; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pangalay; Yakan tumahik; Yakan wedding and festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Basilan; Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Lanao del Sur

Record ID: PH-1903600000 | PSGC: 1903600000 | Region: Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) | 2024
population: 1,368,137

Lanao del Sur reflects the traditions of Maranao communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Maranao communities
Festivals and festivities	Sarimanok Festival; Sagayan Festival; Marawi Week of Peace
Food and culinary culture	palapa; rendang; dodol; pater; tiyateg
Historical and cultural places	Lake Lanao; Aga Khan Museum; torogan heritage houses; Marawi mosques and old Dansalan sites
Heroes and notable figures	Amai Pakpak; Maranao sultans, ulama, Darangen chanters and okir artists
History snapshot	Lanao del Sur was created in 1959 from old Lanao Province and remains the heartland of Maranao culture. Lake Lanao, the torogan, Darangen epic, and the 2017 Marawi siege are central to its history and memory.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; horse racing and riding games; boat races; silat; archery
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, babandil, kudyapi, kubing, gabbang, biyula, and suling; kulintang; agung; gandingan; dabakan; kudyapi
Music and oral traditions	Darangen epic, bayok and lyrical chants, kulintang repertoire, Islamic devotional recitation, Maranao and Maguindanaon vocal music, and Sama/Yakan traditions; Darangen; bayok; Maranao kulintang music
Languages and speech varieties	Maranao; Filipino; Arabic in religious education; English
Folk and ritual dances	singkil; sagayan; kapa malong-malong; asik
Retrieval aliases	Lanao del Sur; Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Tawi-Tawi

Record ID: PH-1907000000 | PSGC: 1907000000 | Region: Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) | 2024 population: 482,645

Tawi-Tawi reflects the traditions of Sama, Jama Mapun, Bajau and Tausug communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Sama, Jama Mapun, Bajau and Tausug communities
Festivals and festivities	Kamahardikaan sin Tawi-Tawi; Agal-Agal Festival; Pakaradjaan celebrations
Food and culinary culture	tiyula itum; seafood; native Sama dishes; cassava cakes
Historical and cultural places	Sheikh Karimul Makhdum Mosque; Bud Bongao tombs; Simunul heritage sites; Bongao museum and maritime settlements
Heroes and notable figures	Sheikh Karimul Makhdum; Haja Amina Appi; Sama and Bajau cultural bearers
History snapshot	Tawi-Tawi became a province in 1973 and is one of the country’s oldest centers of Islamic tradition, linked to the 1380 mosque in Simunul. Its culture is maritime, multilingual, and strongly shaped by Sama, Jama Mapun and Bajau communities.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; horse racing and riding games; boat races; silat; archery; boat races; sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; fishing contests
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, babandil, kudyapi, kubing, gabbang, biyula, and suling; gabbang; kulintang; agung; biyula; suling
Music and oral traditions	Darangen epic, bayok and lyrical chants, kulintang repertoire, Islamic devotional recitation, Maranao and Maguindanaon vocal music, and Sama/Yakan traditions; Sama leleng and vocal traditions; Islamic devotional music; gong music
Languages and speech varieties	Sama languages; Jama Mapun; Sinama/Bajau varieties; Tausug; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	pangalay/igal; Sama and Bajau boat and wedding dances
Retrieval aliases	Tawi-Tawi; Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Maguindanao del Norte

Record ID: PH-1908700000 | PSGC: 1908700000 | Region: Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) | 2024
population: 1,124,811

Maguindanao del Norte reflects the traditions of Maguindanaon, Iranun, Teduray, Lambangian and settler communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Maguindanaon, Iranun, Teduray, Lambangian and settler communities
Festivals and festivities	Sagayan Festival; Shariff Kabunsuan cultural celebrations; Inaul-related events
Food and culinary culture	pastil; palapa; tinagtag; tiyula itum
Historical and cultural places	Tamontaka Church; Sultanate settlements; Grand Mosque and Kutawato sites in nearby Cotabato City; weaving communities
Heroes and notable figures	Sultan Kudarat; Salipada K. Pendatun; Maguindanaon and Iranun leaders
History snapshot	The province was created in 2022 when Maguindanao was divided. It occupies part of the historic heartland of the Sultanate of Maguindanao and includes important Iranun, Teduray, and Maguindanaon communities.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; horse racing and riding games; boat races; silat; archery
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, babandil, kudyapi, kubing, gabbang, biyula, and suling
Music and oral traditions	Darangen epic, bayok and lyrical chants, kulintang repertoire, Islamic devotional recitation, Maranao and Maguindanaon vocal music, and Sama/Yakan traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Maguindanaon; Iranun; Teduray; Lambangian; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sagayan; kapa malong-malong; asik; Iranun and Teduray dances
Retrieval aliases	Maguindanao del Norte; Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Maguindanao del Sur

Record ID: PH-1908800000 | PSGC: 1908800000 | Region: Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) | 2024
population: 813,243

Maguindanao del Sur reflects the traditions of Maguindanaon, Dulangan Manobo and other communities. Its cultural profile combines local foodways, festivals, oral and musical traditions, historic memory, Indigenous or vernacular languages, and community performance.

Cultural communities	Maguindanaon, Dulangan Manobo and other communities
Festivals and festivities	Inaul Festival; Sagayan Festival; Pakaradjaan celebrations
Food and culinary culture	pastil; tinagtag; dodol; palapa
Historical and cultural places	Buluan Lake; Inaul weaving centers; Datu Uto and Sultanate heritage areas; Mt. Firis cultural landscape
Heroes and notable figures	Datu Uto; Datu Ali; Sultan Kudarat; inaul master weavers
History snapshot	Created in 2022 from the former Maguindanao Province, Maguindanao del Sur contains communities deeply linked to the Sultanate of Maguindanao, inland agriculture, conflict and peacebuilding, and the inaul weaving tradition.
Games and recreation	sipa/sepak takraw; sungka; horse racing and riding games; boat races; silat; archery
Instruments and material culture	kulintang, agung, gandingan, dabakan, babandil, kudyapi, kubing, gabbang, biyula, and suling
Music and oral traditions	Darangen epic, bayok and lyrical chants, kulintang repertoire, Islamic devotional recitation, Maranao and Maguindanaon vocal music, and Sama/Yakan traditions
Languages and speech varieties	Maguindanaon; Dulangan Manobo; Filipino; English
Folk and ritual dances	sagayan; asik; kapa malong-malong; Inaul festival dances
Retrieval aliases	Maguindanao del Sur; Bangsamoro Autonomous Region In Muslim Mindanao (BARMM); Philippine province culture
Scope note	Representative, non-exhaustive profile; verify current event dates and local naming with the relevant LGU or cultural office.

Selected Heroes and Historical Figures by Place Association

Place association	Selected figures
Ilocos Norte	Juan Luna; Antonio Luna; Gregorio Aglipay; Artemio Ricarte; Josefa Llanes Escoda
Ilocos Sur and Abra	Diego Silang; Gabriela Silang; Pedro Bukaneg; Leona Florentino; Jose Burgos
Pangasinan	Juan de la Cruz Palaris; Victorio Edades; legendary figure Princess Urduja
Aurora	Manuel L. Quezon; Aurora Aragon-Quezon
Bataan	Tomas Pinpin; Cayetano Arellano; defenders of Bataan
Bulacan	Marcelo H. del Pilar; Gregorio del Pilar; Francisco Balagtas; Trinidad Tecson; Pio Valenzuela
Nueva Ecija	Mariano Llanera; Manuel Tinio; Epifanio de los Santos
Pampanga	Jose Abad Santos; Vicente Manansala; Diosdado Macapagal; Luis Taruc
Tarlac	Francisco Makabulos; Carlos P. Romulo; Benigno Aquino Jr.
Zambales	Ramon Magsaysay
Batangas	Apolinario Mabini; Miguel Malvar; Marcela Agoncillo; Felipe Agoncillo
Cavite	Emilio Aguinaldo; Mariano Alvarez; Baldomero Aguinaldo; Mariano Gómez
Laguna	José Rizal; Pedro Pelaez
Quezon	Apolinario de la Cruz (Hermano Pule); Claro M. Recto
Rizal	Juan Sumulong; Carlos “Botong” Francisco; Lucio San Pedro
Camarines Norte	Wenceslao Vinzons; José Maria Panganiban
Albay	Simeon Ola; Potenciano Gregorio
Iloilo	Graciano López Jaena; Teresa Magbanua; Martin Delgado; Magdalena Jalandoni
Negros Occidental	Papa Isio; Aniceto Lacson; Juan Araneta
Negros Oriental	Pantaleon Villegas (Leon Kilat); Eddie Romero
Bohol	Francisco Dagohoy; Tamblot; Carlos P. Garcia
Cebu	Lapu-Lapu; Leon Kilat; Sergio Osmeña; Vicente Sotto
Eastern Samar	Eugenio Daza; Valeriano Abanador; Balangiga resistance figures
Northern Samar	Juan Ponce Sumuroy
Bukidnon	Datu Mampaalong; Indigenous cultural masters and ancestral-domain leaders
Misamis Occidental	José F. Ozámiz
Sulu	Panglima Hassan; Hadji Butu; Sultan Jamalul Kiram II
Lanao del Sur	Amai Pakpak; Maranao sultans, ulama and Darangen chanters
Maguindanao and Sultan Kudarat	Sultan Muhammad Dipatuan Kudarat; Datu Uto; Datu Ali; Salipada K. Pendatun
Tawi-Tawi	Sheikh Karimul Makhdum; Haja Amina Appi
Basilan	Ambalang Ausalin; Uwang Ahadas
South Cotabato	Lang Dulay and Tboli cultural masters
Kalinga	Macli-ing Dulag; Whang-od Oggay

Sources, Verification and Update Notes

This knowledge base is a structured reference, not a substitute for a full ethnographic or local-history study. The following sources were used as the principal verification framework. Province entries are representative and were written to support fast retrieval rather than exhaustive documentation.

Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)	Philippine Standard Geographic Code (PSGC), 31 March 2026 datafile and provincial listings. Used for the current 18-region and 82-province structure, PSGC codes, 2024 population data, the Negros Island Region, and the transfer of Sulu to Region IX.
National Commission for Culture and the Arts (NCCA)	Talapamana / Philippine Registry of Cultural Property, Sentro Rizal resources, National Living Treasures materials, and cultural-community references.
National Historical Commission of the Philippines (NHCP)	Philippine Historic Site Registry, National Memory Project, local-history collections, museums and hero-related resources.
Department of Tourism and Tourism Promotions Board	Destination profiles, cultural and festival descriptions, and official regional tourism materials. Event dates must still be verified with LGUs.
UNESCO	World Heritage and Intangible Cultural Heritage records, including the Hudhud, Darangen, Buklog, tugging rituals and games, Baroque Churches, Vigan, and the Rice Terraces of the Philippine Cordilleras.
Official provincial, city and municipal sources	Used as a cross-checking framework for local festivals, museums, heritage sites and cultural programs.
Earlier province knowledge base	The prior "Philippine Provinces Enriched Knowledge Base" supplied the initial province-level food, tourism and festival framework, then was expanded and administratively updated for this edition.

Update priority. Review the PSGC structure whenever the PSA publishes a new quarterly update. Review festival entries annually and after major LGU announcements. Heritage-site status, access rules, and event schedules are time-sensitive.

Suggested system prompt rule: "Answer from the retrieved Philippine Culture Knowledge Base. Prefer province-specific records. Distinguish between province-wide facts, regional traditions, and practices of a particular cultural community. Do not claim that a shared tradition is exclusive to one province. When dates or schedules are requested, say that current LGU announcements must be checked."